



COVERS LOGIC PRO 11 AND 12 · AN EBOOK BY DANNY MCCARTHY

Logic Pro Crash Course.

249 tricks that actually work. Every trick cites its source. Anything unconfirmed was cut.

TRICKS

249

Each one cites its source

SECTIONS

19

Setup to mixing to export

CLICKABLE

100%

Every entry is a link

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Every entry is a link. Click it and you are there.

Start Here

If you have never used Logic Pro, do these ten steps in order. By the end you will have played a sound, recorded it, and saved a file you can send to someone. Underlined words are explained in the Glossary at the back of the book.

Every trick marked START HERE in the book is safe for day one.

1 Learn the four parts of the screen

The control bar runs across the top: play, record, volume, and the display showing where you are in the song and its tempo. The big middle area is the Tracks area, where you record and arrange. The Library sits on the left and holds sounds. The Inspector shows settings for whatever you have selected.

SOURCE [Apple — Main window interface \(10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Inspector interface](#)

2 Know what a track and a region are

A track is one lane in the Tracks area: one instrument or one microphone. A region is a block of recorded audio or MIDI sitting on a track. You move, copy and cut regions to build a song.

SOURCE [Apple — Main window interface \(10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Create tracks](#)

3 Add a track

Click the Add Tracks button (the + above the track headers). In the New Tracks dialog pick Software Instrument to play sounds from a keyboard, Audio to record a microphone or guitar, or Drummer for a virtual drummer that plays a region for you.

SOURCE [Apple — Create tracks](#) · [Apple — Drummer overview \(10.7 guide\)](#)

4 Pick a sound in the Library

Select the track, open the Library, choose a category on the left and a patch on the right. The track now plays that sound.



SOURCE [Apple — Choose a patch](#)

5

Play it without a keyboard

No MIDI keyboard? Turn on Musical Typing and play notes on your computer keys. Z and X move down and up an octave. A software instrument track must be selected.

⌘K

SOURCE [Apple — Play software instruments](#)

6

Play, stop, and go back to the start

Space starts and stops playback. Return jumps the playhead back to the beginning of the project.

SPACE

SOURCE [Apple — Transport key commands \(10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Control playback \(10.7 guide\)](#)

7

Record

Select the track, press R, play, then press Space to stop. A new region appears on the track with what you played.

R

SOURCE [Apple — Record to multiple audio tracks](#)

8

Undo anything

Made a mistake? Undo steps back one edit at a time; Redo puts it back. Experiment freely.

⌘Z

SOURCE [Apple — Undo and redo edits](#)

9

Save often

Save writes the project to disk. Logic also keeps backups of earlier saves you can revert to from the File menu.

⌘S

SOURCE [Apple — Use project alternatives and backups](#)

10

Export a file you can share

Bounce turns your project into an audio file, such as a WAV or MP3, that plays anywhere.

⌘B

SOURCE [Apple — Bounce a project to an audio file](#)

I Want To...

You do not need to know what a feature is called. Find what you are trying to do below and go straight to the tricks that do it. Numbers are trick numbers; tricks tagged START HERE come first in each list.

GET STARTED AND SET UP LOGIC 29

- 006 Leave Allow Quick Punch-In on [START HERE](#)
- 013 Turn on "Show help tags" [START HERE](#)
- 027 Hit ⌘S often: every save backs a backup [START HERE](#)
- 007 Make the bar and the beat click sound different
- 008 Turn on scrubbing with audio in the Tracks area
- 011 Turn on Enable Complete Features first
- 012 Colour regions individually, not by track
- 023 Save a Session Start template and set it as the default
- 025 Give each colour a fixed meaning
- 026 Make a Project Alternative before big changes
- 029 Save the project as a Package so it travels
- 001 Run two buffer sizes, not one
- 002 Set Processing Threads to Automatic
- 003 Choose the right Multithreading mode
- 004 Set Process Buffer Range to Large to avoid overloads
- 005 Uncheck Software Monitoring if you monitor through your interface
- 009 Leave the MIDI Reset Messages at their defaults
- 010 Fix doubled notes from a controller
- 014 Set Auto Set Locators to By Region Selection
- 015 Turn on "Limit Dragging to One Direction" in the Tracks area
- 016 Read the Clean Up list before you confirm it
- 017 Set your sample rate before you record, not after
- 018 Set the recording bit depth in Settings > Recording
- 019 Turn on Smart Tempo "Keep Project Tempo" by default
- 020 Stop new recordings arriving pre-quantised
- 021 Check Tuning when a synth sounds subtly off
- 022 Copy your assets into the project so it travels
- 024 Save your starting channel strip as a setting

028 Move the Sound Library to an external drive on purpose

RECORD VOCALS OR AN INSTRUMENT 39

- 006 Leave Allow Quick Punch-In on [START HERE](#)
- 049 Capture the last thing you played, even when not recording [START HERE](#)
- 079 Name the track before you record, always [START HERE](#)
- 080 Record-enable multiple tracks at once [START HERE](#)
- 081 ⌘. discards the take you just recorded [START HERE](#)
- 086 Give the performer a click they can feel [START HERE](#)
- 224 Flashback Capture retrieves what you just played [START HERE](#)
- 007 Make the bar and the beat click sound different
- 057 Merge cycle takes to layer a part pass by pass
- 060 Keep one "sketch" instrument track loaded at all times
- 074 Quantise only the notes that need it
- 075 Aim your peaks at -12 to -18 dBFS
- 076 Track at the lowest I/O buffer your Mac can handle
- 077 Turn on Low Latency Monitoring mode instead of disabling plug-ins one by one
- 078 Count-in and pre-roll are either/or — pick the right one
- 082 Watch the take list, not the waveform
- 084 Use Input Monitoring rather than record enable to rehearse
- 085 Turn off Software Monitoring when your interface can monitor
- 093 Put take-switching on keys you choose
- 094 Save your comp as a new comp before changing it
- 095 Move a comp edit point without redoing the comp
- 125 Thin dense automation after recording a controller pass
- 150 Know the four modes and pick deliberately
- 164 Colour your tracks and the mixer follows

- 186 Use Project Alternatives instead of Save As
- 212 Use Pitch Source to keep parts off the Chord track
- 214 Use it on your own rough mixes, not just other people's records
- 222 Use Bypass Below to keep the low end clean
- 225 MIDI capture works with the transport stopped
- 232 Chord ID reads chords off audio, not just MIDI
- 238 Reanalyze and try each Character
- 245 Note your current I/O and buffer settings
- 003 Choose the right Multithreading mode
- 010 Fix doubled notes from a controller
- 017 Set your sample rate before you record, not after
- 018 Set the recording bit depth in Settings > Recording
- 019 Turn on Smart Tempo "Keep Project Tempo" by default
- 020 Stop new recordings arriving pre-quantised
- 083 Build a dedicated headphone mix on a bus

PLAY AND RECORD WITH A KEYBOARD 38

- 049 Capture the last thing you played, even when not recording [START HERE](#)
- 050 Use the Step Input Keyboard for parts you cannot play [START HERE](#)
- 051 Draw notes with the Pencil, delete with the Eraser [START HERE](#)
- 062 Select all notes of the same pitch in one click [START HERE](#)
- 141 Convert a Drummer region to MIDI and edit it by hand [START HERE](#)
- 224 Flashback Capture retrieves what you just played [START HERE](#)
- 052 Use the Chord Trigger MIDI plugin to play chords with one finger
- 053 Force everything into key with Transposer
- 054 Use Arpeggiator to generate parts, then commit them
- 055 Transpose without touching the notes
- 057 Merge cycle takes to layer a part pass by pass
- 058 Freeze the instrument as soon as the part is done
- 059 Commit a MIDI region to audio with Bounce in Place
- 060 Keep one "sketch" instrument track loaded at all times
- 061 Use Note Repeat for hi-hats and rolls
- 070 Show the automation lane inside the Piano Roll
- 134 Use the Step Sequencer on any software instrument
- 150 Know the four modes and pick deliberately
- 154 Set the root key correctly or nothing will be in tune
- 155 Shuffle the slice MIDI to rearrange the break
- 184 Put your key commands on the Touch Bar or a controller button
- 195 Use Follow Rhythm Of to lock players together

- 202 Pair Bass Player with Studio Bass for its slides
- 206 Convert to MIDI, then thin out the part
- 207 Use Keyboard Player as a writing tool, not a final part
- 210 Generate chords from an existing region
- 225 MIDI capture works with the transport stopped
- 227 Synth Player lives inside Bass Player and Keyboard Player
- 228 Pick the Synth Keyboard style before you touch anything else
- 231 Point Synth Player at a third-party synth
- 232 Chord ID reads chords off audio, not just MIDI
- 234 Everything downstream follows the Chord track
- 009 Leave the MIDI Reset Messages at their defaults
- 010 Fix doubled notes from a controller
- 021 Check Tuning when a synth sounds subtly off
- 036 Use aliases for parts that must stay identical
- 056 Use the Modifier MIDI plugin to reassign a controller
- 151 Use Slice mode with Transient detection on any break

MAKE A BEAT 45

- 086 Give the performer a click they can feel [START HERE](#)
- 140 Turn individual kit pieces on and off per region [START HERE](#)
- 141 Convert a Drummer region to MIDI and edit it by hand [START HERE](#)
- 146 Copy a pad with Control-click [START HERE](#)
- 213 Split any mixed audio into stems [START HERE](#)
- 011 Turn on Enable Complete Features first
- 025 Give each colour a fixed meaning
- 043 Use markers for notes to self, not just sections
- 061 Use Note Repeat for hi-hats and rolls
- 067 Place a note between grid divisions
- 088 Use Snap Regions to Relative Value for off-grid parts
- 127 Give every row a different step rate
- 128 Use the row's Playback Mode for variation
- 129 Increase pattern length beyond 16 steps
- 130 Use Note Repeat for rolls without drawing them
- 131 Use Gate to shorten hits and Tie to lengthen them
- 132 Tie steps together for sustained notes
- 133 Clear a step to reset all its edit-mode values
- 134 Use the Step Sequencer on any software instrument
- 135 Automate plugin parameters per step
- 136 Build a library of pattern regions
- 137 Use Skip and Loop Start/End to reshape a row
- 138 Use Complexity and Intensity, then the kit-piece sliders
- 139 Change the drummer, not just the preset
- 142 Use the Details panel for feel, ghost notes and hi-hat

- 143 Swap and tune kit pieces in Drum Kit Designer
- 144 Drag any audio file straight onto a pad
- 145 Every pad is its own channel strip
- 147 Use Pad Controls for quick shaping
- 148 Use the main track for the whole kit
- 149 Save your kit as a patch
- 169 Noise Gate — use the side chain to key one sound from another
- 170 Enveloper — reshape a transient without a compressor
- 174 Delay Designer — build rhythmic patterns, not echoes
- 177 Phat FX — one plugin, an entire character chain
- 195 Use Follow Rhythm Of to lock players together
- 203 Set the Bass Player to follow a specific track's rhythm
- 206 Convert to MIDI, then thin out the part
- 208 Try the Synth Player styles, not just piano
- 228 Pick the Synth Keyboard style before you touch anything else
- 229 Synth Bass ships with three distinct characters
- 234 Everything downstream follows the Chord track
- 039 Use Track Stacks to collapse instrument families
- 167 Compressor — use the side-chain filter before reaching for a multiband
- 221 Try it before the compressor on the drum bus

WRITE CHORDS AND MELODIES 40

- 049 Capture the last thing you played, even when not recording START HERE
- 050 Use the Step Input Keyboard for parts you cannot play START HERE
- 051 Draw notes with the Pencil, delete with the Eraser START HERE
- 062 Select all notes of the same pitch in one click START HERE
- 089 T opens the Tool menu, T again closes it START HERE
- 157 X shows and hides the Mixer START HERE
- 181 Open Key Commands with `⌘K` and use the search box START HERE
- 209 Show the Chord track in Global Tracks START HERE
- 040 Loop an arrangement section with one key
- 045 Know what the number keys actually do
- 052 Use the Chord Trigger MIDI plugin to play chords with one finger
- 053 Force everything into key with Transposer
- 054 Use Arpeggiator to generate parts, then commit them
- 055 Transpose without touching the notes
- 057 Merge cycle takes to layer a part pass by pass
- 058 Freeze the instrument as soon as the part is done

- 059 Commit a MIDI region to audio with Bounce in Place
- 060 Keep one “sketch” instrument track loaded at all times
- 061 Use Note Repeat for hi-hats and rolls
- 087 Trim to the playhead from either direction
- 093 Put take-switching on keys you choose
- 154 Set the root key correctly or nothing will be in tune
- 169 Noise Gate — use the side chain to key one sound from another
- 174 Delay Designer — build rhythmic patterns, not echoes
- 182 Save your key commands as a set and back it up
- 184 Put your key commands on the Touch Bar or a controller button
- 195 Use Follow Rhythm Of to lock players together
- 204 Use the left- and right-hand controls independently
- 208 Try the Synth Player styles, not just piano
- 210 Generate chords from an existing region
- 211 Resize chords by dragging their lower edges
- 227 Synth Player lives inside Bass Player and Keyboard Player
- 228 Pick the Synth Keyboard style before you touch anything else
- 231 Point Synth Player at a third-party synth
- 233 Check Chord ID's chords before you build on them
- 234 Everything downstream follows the Chord track
- 235 Run Chord ID on your own old bounces
- 242 Back up your key commands and channel strip settings
- 247 Read the new Key Commands list for additions
- 056 Use the Modifier MIDI plugin to reassign a controller

FIX TIMING 11

- 068 Change velocity by dragging with the Velocity tool
- 072 Quantise from the region inspector, not destructively
- 074 Quantise only the notes that need it
- 078 Count-in and pre-roll are either/or — pick the right one
- 092 Lock events so tempo changes cannot move them
- 142 Use the Details panel for feel, ghost notes and hi-hat
- 019 Turn on Smart Tempo “Keep Project Tempo” by default
- 020 Stop new recordings arriving pre-quantised
- 100 Quantise audio with Flex enabled
- 151 Use Slice mode with Transient detection on any break
- 153 Use Flex and Follow Tempo to lock a loop to the project

FIX PITCH AND TUNING 10

- 062 Select all notes of the same pitch in one click START HERE
- 066 `⌘`-drag a note to duplicate it

- 147 Use Pad Controls for quick shaping
- 152 Drag audio directly from the Tracks area into a loaded Quick Sampler
- 154 Set the root key correctly or nothing will be in tune
- 212 Use Pitch Source to keep parts off the Chord track
- 017 Set your sample rate before you record, not after
- 021 Check Tuning when a synth sounds subtly off
- 101 Use Flex Pitch to fix a single flat note
- 153 Use Flex and Follow Tempo to lock a loop to the project

CUT, COPY AND MOVE PARTS 77

- 030 Use the Arrangement track to move whole sections START HERE
- 032 ⌘-drag an arrangement marker to duplicate a section START HERE
- 033 Delete a section and close the gap START HERE
- 042 Keep a “graveyard” track at the bottom START HERE
- 051 Draw notes with the Pencil, delete with the Eraser START HERE
- 062 Select all notes of the same pitch in one click START HERE
- 089 T opens the Tool menu, T again closes it START HERE
- 091 Select everything after this point in one keystroke START HERE
- 108 Make Marquee your ⌘-click tool START HERE
- 109 Play just the marquee selection START HERE
- 110 Cut a hole in every track at once START HERE
- 118 Delete an automation point without dragging it START HERE
- 141 Convert a Drummer region to MIDI and edit it by hand START HERE
- 146 Copy a pad with Control-click START HERE
- 158 ⌘-click a fader to reset it to 0 dB START HERE
- 213 Split any mixed audio into stems START HERE
- 217 Make an instrumental with one preset START HERE
- 034 Insert silence between the locators
- 035 Resize arrangement markers to fit your sections
- 063 Change note length numerically in the Event Float
- 064 Force legato to fix gappy pads
- 065 Trim overlaps automatically
- 066 ⌘-drag a note to duplicate it
- 067 Place a note between grid divisions
- 068 Change velocity by dragging with the Velocity tool
- 069 Change a selection's velocity without flattening it
- 070 Show the automation lane inside the Piano Roll
- 071 Colour notes by velocity to read dynamics instantly

- 072 Quantise from the region inspector, not destructively
- 073 Use Q-Strength to keep the human feel
- 074 Quantise only the notes that need it
- 082 Watch the take list, not the waveform
- 087 Trim to the playhead from either direction
- 088 Use Snap Regions to Relative Value for off-grid parts
- 090 ⌘ is your secondary tool
- 092 Lock events so tempo changes cannot move them
- 093 Put take-switching on keys you choose
- 094 Save your comp as a new comp before changing it
- 095 Move a comp edit point without redoing the comp
- 096 Curve the fade after you draw it
- 097 Use “Remove Silence from Audio Region” on a live kit or spoken word
- 098 Stop clicks at region starts with a short fade
- 104 Change region level non-destructively with Gain
- 105 Reclaim disk space with Project Management > Clean Up
- 106 Reverse a region, destructively or not
- 107 Commit edits with Bounce Regions in Place
- 111 Set the locators to the marquee instantly
- 112 Marquee automation to move only that range
- 113 Use marquee to create a drop
- 116 Use Latch mode for almost everything
- 117 Never leave a track in Write mode
- 120 Trim existing automation up or down
- 122 Marquee a range, then drag the line to change only that section
- 124 Delete all automation on a track in one command
- 125 Thin dense automation after recording a controller pass
- 132 Tie steps together for sustained notes
- 133 Clear a step to reset all its edit-mode values
- 163 Set sends to pre-fader for headphone mixes and effects that must stay constant
- 166 Drag plugins between insert slots and between channels
- 170 Enveloper — reshape a transient without a compressor
- 176 Tape Delay — turn up Flutter for analogue character
- 198 Nudge Complexity or Intensity before you rebuild a part
- 206 Convert to MIDI, then thin out the part
- 211 Resize chords by dragging their lower edges
- 216 Try single stems as layers first
- 236 Preview sound packs before you download them
- 243 Consolidate and archive your three most important projects
- 015 Turn on “Limit Dragging to One Direction” in the Tracks area
- 016 Read the Clean Up list before you confirm it
- 022 Copy your assets into the project so it travels

- 099 Add flex markers either side before you move one
- 100 Quantise audio with Flex enabled
- 101 Use Flex Pitch to fix a single flat note
- 102 Reset all Flex edits rather than undoing repeatedly
- 103 Use the Audio File Editor for true destructive edits
- 114 Use Region automation for anything that belongs to the part
- 160 Use VCA faders for level groups without changing routing

LOOP OR REPEAT A SECTION 20

- 086 Give the performer a click they can feel [START HERE](#)
- 189 ⌘B bounces the project or the current section [START HERE](#)
- 040 Loop an arrangement section with one key
- 047 Use the Cycle area as a bookmark
- 057 Merge cycle takes to layer a part pass by pass
- 061 Use Note Repeat for hi-hats and rolls
- 111 Set the locators to the marquee instantly
- 130 Use Note Repeat for rolls without drawing them
- 137 Use Skip and Loop Start/End to reshape a row
- 150 Know the four modes and pick deliberately
- 152 Drag audio directly from the Tracks area into a loaded Quick Sampler
- 175 Stereo Delay — set different times per side
- 176 Tape Delay — turn up Flutter for analogue character
- 192 Leave room for tails at the end of the bounce range
- 212 Use Pitch Source to keep parts off the Chord track
- 014 Set Auto Set Locators to By Region Selection
- 036 Use aliases for parts that must stay identical
- 102 Reset all Flex edits rather than undoing repeatedly
- 151 Use Slice mode with Transient detection on any break
- 153 Use Flex and Follow Tempo to lock a loop to the project

ARRANGE A WHOLE SONG 29

- 030 Use the Arrangement track to move whole sections [START HERE](#)
- 031 Drag one arrangement marker onto another to swap sections [START HERE](#)
- 032 ⌘-drag an arrangement marker to duplicate a section [START HERE](#)
- 033 Delete a section and close the gap [START HERE](#)
- 038 Colour-code sections, not instruments [START HERE](#)
- 041 Mute regions instead of deleting them while experimenting [START HERE](#)
- 042 Keep a “graveyard” track at the bottom [START HERE](#)
- 044 Drag-zoom to any area with ^⌘ [START HERE](#)

- 140 Turn individual kit pieces on and off per region [START HERE](#)
- 157 X shows and hides the Mixer [START HERE](#)
- 189 ⌘B bounces the project or the current section [START HERE](#)
- 200 Adjust the Complexity slider before you adjust anything else [START HERE](#)
- 034 Insert silence between the locators
- 035 Resize arrangement markers to fit your sections
- 037 Make a folder out of a section
- 040 Loop an arrangement section with one key
- 043 Use markers for notes to self, not just sections
- 048 Toggle Catch to stop the screen running away
- 095 Move a comp edit point without redoing the comp
- 106 Reverse a region, destructively or not
- 112 Marquee automation to move only that range
- 113 Use marquee to create a drop
- 122 Marquee a range, then drag the line to change only that section
- 178 Remix FX — perform DJ effects live
- 196 Session Player performances are per region, so write in sections
- 248 Test your bounce path end to end before you need it
- 036 Use aliases for parts that must stay identical
- 039 Use Track Stacks to collapse instrument families
- 103 Use the Audio File Editor for true destructive edits

SAMPLE AND CHOP SOUNDS 13

- 076 Track at the lowest I/O buffer your Mac can handle
- 144 Drag any audio file straight onto a pad
- 147 Use Pad Controls for quick shaping
- 150 Know the four modes and pick deliberately
- 152 Drag audio directly from the Tracks area into a loaded Quick Sampler
- 154 Set the root key correctly or nothing will be in tune
- 155 Shuffle the slice MIDI to rearrange the break
- 156 Convert Quick Sampler to Sampler for full control
- 177 Phat FX — one plugin, an entire character chain
- 178 Remix FX — perform DJ effects live
- 103 Use the Audio File Editor for true destructive edits
- 151 Use Slice mode with Transient detection on any break
- 153 Use Flex and Follow Tempo to lock a loop to the project

SPLIT A SONG INTO PARTS 5

- 213 Split any mixed audio into stems [START HERE](#)
- 217 Make an instrumental with one preset [START HERE](#)

- 215 Solo each stem and listen before you commit
- 216 Try single stems as layers first
- 218 Splitting adds rather than replaces

BALANCE AND MIX YOUR TRACKS 38

- 041 Mute regions instead of deleting them while experimenting START HERE
- 042 Keep a “graveyard” track at the bottom START HERE
- 080 Record-enable multiple tracks at once START HERE
- 157 X shows and hides the Mixer START HERE
- 158 ⌘-click a fader to reset it to 0 dB START HERE
- 165 Bypass with ⌘-click, browse with the slot arrows START HERE
- 008 Turn on scrubbing with audio in the Tracks area
- 077 Turn on Low Latency Monitoring mode instead of disabling plug-ins one by one
- 084 Use Input Monitoring rather than record enable to rehearse
- 104 Change region level non-destructively with Gain
- 107 Commit edits with Bounce Regions in Place
- 117 Never leave a track in Write mode
- 120 Trim existing automation up or down
- 136 Build a library of pattern regions
- 145 Every pad is its own channel strip
- 159 ⌘-click Solo for exclusive solo
- 163 Set sends to pre-fader for headphone mixes and effects that must stay constant
- 164 Colour your tracks and the mixer follows
- 166 Drag plugins between insert slots and between channels
- 174 Delay Designer — build rhythmic patterns, not echoes
- 179 Gain — use it to check phase, not just level
- 187 Keep a reference track in every project, muted at the top
- 190 Check the Normalize setting before you bounce
- 191 Bounce offline unless external MIDI or inputs are involved
- 201 Shape the bass articulations in Details
- 215 Solo each stem and listen before you commit
- 218 Splitting adds rather than replaces
- 220 Use Drive and Level Out together to stay level-matched
- 024 Save your starting channel strip as a setting
- 028 Move the Sound Library to an external drive on purpose
- 039 Use Track Stacks to collapse instrument families
- 056 Use the Modifier MIDI plugin to reassign a controller
- 083 Build a dedicated headphone mix on a bus
- 103 Use the Audio File Editor for true destructive edits
- 160 Use VCA faders for level groups without changing routing
- 161 Use Summing Stacks for processing groups
- 162 Create a send and Logic makes the aux for you

- 221 Try it before the compressor on the drum bus

ADD EFFECTS LIKE REVERB, EQ AND COMPRESSION 50

- 165 Bypass with ⌘-click, browse with the slot arrows START HERE
- 007 Make the bar and the beat click sound different
- 023 Save a Session Start template and set it as the default
- 052 Use the Chord Trigger MIDI plugin to play chords with one finger
- 054 Use Arpeggiator to generate parts, then commit them
- 058 Freeze the instrument as soon as the part is done
- 059 Commit a MIDI region to audio with Bounce in Place
- 077 Turn on Low Latency Monitoring mode instead of disabling plug-ins one by one
- 085 Turn off Software Monitoring when your interface can monitor
- 107 Commit edits with Bounce Regions in Place
- 135 Automate plugin parameters per step
- 145 Every pad is its own channel strip
- 147 Use Pad Controls for quick shaping
- 148 Use the main track for the whole kit
- 149 Save your kit as a patch
- 163 Set sends to pre-fader for headphone mixes and effects that must stay constant
- 166 Drag plugins between insert slots and between channels
- 168 Multipressor — use it to control one problem band only
- 169 Noise Gate — use the side chain to key one sound from another
- 170 Enveloper — reshape a transient without a compressor
- 171 Channel EQ — turn on Analyzer and set it to Post
- 172 Match EQ — steal a tone rather than guess at it
- 173 ChromaVerb — use the Damping display as the main control
- 174 Delay Designer — build rhythmic patterns, not echoes
- 175 Stereo Delay — set different times per side
- 176 Tape Delay — turn up Flutter for analogue character
- 177 Phat FX — one plugin, an entire character chain
- 178 Remix FX — perform DJ effects live
- 179 Gain — use it to check phase, not just level
- 180 Test Oscillator — reference tones for calibration
- 183 Save your go-to plug-in chains as channel strip settings
- 191 Bounce offline unless external MIDI or inputs are involved
- 192 Leave room for tails at the end of the bounce range
- 202 Pair Bass Player with Studio Bass for its slides
- 215 Solo each stem and listen before you commit
- 219 ChromaGlow is five saturation models in one plugin

- 220 Use Drive and Level Out together to stay level-matched
- 222 Use Bypass Below to keep the low end clean
- 226 Check plug-in compatibility after updating
- 230 Shape the Pump Bass pump directly
- 231 Point Synth Player at a third-party synth
- 241 Back up the current version before you update
- 244 Check your critical third-party plugins against the new version first
- 024 Save your starting channel strip as a setting
- 056 Use the Modifier MIDI plugin to reassign a controller
- 083 Build a dedicated headphone mix on a bus
- 160 Use VCA faders for level groups without changing routing
- 161 Use Summing Stacks for processing groups
- 167 Compressor — use the side-chain filter before reaching for a multiband
- 221 Try it before the compressor on the drum bus

CHANGE SOMETHING OVER TIME 17

- 030 Use the Arrangement track to move whole sections START HERE
- 031 Drag one arrangement marker onto another to swap sections START HERE
- 115 Press A to toggle automation view START HERE
- 118 Delete an automation point without dragging it START HERE
- 119 Curve an automation line with ^ ⬆ -drag START HERE
- 070 Show the automation lane inside the Piano Roll
- 112 Marquee automation to move only that range
- 116 Use Latch mode for almost everything
- 117 Never leave a track in Write mode
- 120 Trim existing automation up or down
- 121 Use Relative mode to layer a second pass
- 122 Marquee a range, then drag the line to change only that section
- 123 Show several automation lanes at once
- 124 Delete all automation on a track in one command
- 125 Thin dense automation after recording a controller pass
- 126 Snap automation to the grid when it needs to be rhythmic
- 114 Use Region automation for anything that belongs to the part

EXPORT AND SHARE YOUR SONG 17

- 189 ⌘B bounces the project or the current section START HERE
- 054 Use Arpeggiator to generate parts, then commit them
- 058 Freeze the instrument as soon as the part is done

- 059 Commit a MIDI region to audio with Bounce in Place
- 107 Commit edits with Bounce Regions in Place
- 127 Give every row a different step rate
- 152 Drag audio directly from the Tracks area into a loaded Quick Sampler
- 186 Use Project Alternatives instead of Save As
- 188 Name your bounce files with the date
- 190 Check the Normalize setting before you bounce
- 191 Bounce offline unless external MIDI or inputs are involved
- 192 Leave room for tails at the end of the bounce range
- 214 Use it on your own rough mixes, not just other people's records
- 232 Chord ID reads chords off audio, not just MIDI
- 235 Run Chord ID on your own old bounces
- 248 Test your bounce path end to end before you need it
- 039 Use Track Stacks to collapse instrument families

WORK FASTER WITH SHORTCUTS 25

- 044 Drag-zoom to any area with ^ ⌘ START HERE
- 080 Record-enable multiple tracks at once START HERE
- 089 T opens the Tool menu, T again closes it START HERE
- 091 Select everything after this point in one keystroke START HERE
- 181 Open Key Commands with ⌘K and use the search box START HERE
- 189 ⌘B bounces the project or the current section START HERE
- 045 Know what the number keys actually do
- 046 Scroll without the scrollbar
- 047 Use the Cycle area as a bookmark
- 048 Toggle Catch to stop the screen running away
- 087 Trim to the playhead from either direction
- 092 Lock events so tempo changes cannot move them
- 182 Save your key commands as a set and back it up
- 183 Save your go-to plug-in chains as channel strip settings
- 184 Put your key commands on the Touch Bar or a controller button
- 185 Build separate templates for writing, mixing and mastering
- 186 Use Project Alternatives instead of Save As
- 187 Keep a reference track in every project, muted at the top
- 188 Name your bounce files with the date
- 190 Check the Normalize setting before you bounce
- 191 Bounce offline unless external MIDI or inputs are involved
- 192 Leave room for tails at the end of the bounce range
- 193 Colour and name everything before you leave the session
- 194 Save a version before every major change

247 Read the new Key Commands list for additions

STAY ORGANIZED 41

- 013 Turn on "Show help tags" START HERE
- 030 Use the Arrangement track to move whole sections START HERE
- 031 Drag one arrangement marker onto another to swap sections START HERE
- 032 ⌘-drag an arrangement marker to duplicate a section START HERE
- 033 Delete a section and close the gap START HERE
- 038 Colour-code sections, not instruments START HERE
- 041 Mute regions instead of deleting them while experimenting START HERE
- 079 Name the track before you record, always START HERE
- 181 Open Key Commands with ⌘K and use the search box START HERE
- 224 Flashback Capture retrieves what you just played START HERE
- 012 Colour regions individually, not by track
- 025 Give each colour a fixed meaning
- 026 Make a Project Alternative before big changes
- 029 Save the project as a Package so it travels
- 035 Resize arrangement markers to fit your sections
- 037 Make a folder out of a section
- 043 Use markers for notes to self, not just sections
- 045 Know what the number keys actually do
- 068 Change velocity by dragging with the Velocity tool
- 071 Colour notes by velocity to read dynamics instantly
- 082 Watch the take list, not the waveform
- 093 Put take-switching on keys you choose
- 094 Save your comp as a new comp before changing it
- 136 Build a library of pattern regions
- 148 Use the main track for the whole kit
- 149 Save your kit as a patch
- 164 Colour your tracks and the mixer follows
- 182 Save your key commands as a set and back it up
- 184 Put your key commands on the Touch Bar or a controller button
- 185 Build separate templates for writing, mixing and mastering
- 188 Name your bounce files with the date
- 193 Colour and name everything before you leave the session
- 218 Splitting adds rather than replaces
- 222 Use Bypass Below to keep the low end clean
- 237 Missing sounds after upgrading? Install the Legacy packs
- 241 Back up the current version before you update

242 Back up your key commands and channel strip settings

003 Choose the right Multithreading mode

028 Move the Sound Library to an external drive on purpose

099 Add flex markers either side before you move one

161 Use Summing Stacks for processing groups

FIX GLITCHES, LAG OR CRACKLES 34

- 006 Leave Allow Quick Punch-In on START HERE
- 013 Turn on "Show help tags" START HERE
- 027 Hit ⌘S often: every save banks a backup START HERE
- 007 Make the bar and the beat click sound different
- 008 Turn on scrubbing with audio in the Tracks area
- 011 Turn on Enable Complete Features first
- 012 Colour regions individually, not by track
- 023 Save a Session Start template and set it as the default
- 025 Give each colour a fixed meaning
- 026 Make a Project Alternative before big changes
- 029 Save the project as a Package so it travels
- 076 Track at the lowest I/O buffer your Mac can handle
- 077 Turn on Low Latency Monitoring mode instead of disabling plug-ins one by one
- 084 Use Input Monitoring rather than record enable to rehearse
- 190 Check the Normalize setting before you bounce
- 245 Note your current I/O and buffer settings
- 001 Run two buffer sizes, not one
- 002 Set Processing Threads to Automatic
- 003 Choose the right Multithreading mode
- 004 Set Process Buffer Range to Large to avoid overloads
- 005 Uncheck Software Monitoring if you monitor through your interface
- 009 Leave the MIDI Reset Messages at their defaults
- 010 Fix doubled notes from a controller
- 014 Set Auto Set Locators to By Region Selection
- 015 Turn on "Limit Dragging to One Direction" in the Tracks area
- 016 Read the Clean Up list before you confirm it
- 017 Set your sample rate before you record, not after
- 018 Set the recording bit depth in Settings > Recording
- 019 Turn on Smart Tempo "Keep Project Tempo" by default
- 020 Stop new recordings arriving pre-quantised
- 021 Check Tuning when a synth sounds subtly off
- 022 Copy your assets into the project so it travels
- 024 Save your starting channel strip as a setting
- 028 Move the Sound Library to an external drive on purpose

DON'T LOSE YOUR WORK 20

- 027 Hit ⌘S often: every save backs a backup [START HERE](#)
- 041 Mute regions instead of deleting them while experimenting [START HERE](#)
- 158 ⌘-click a fader to reset it to 0 dB [START HERE](#)
- 011 Turn on Enable Complete Features first
- 023 Save a Session Start template and set it as the default
- 026 Make a Project Alternative before big changes
- 029 Save the project as a Package so it travels
- 094 Save your comp as a new comp before changing it
- 105 Reclaim disk space with Project Management > Clean Up
- 136 Build a library of pattern regions
- 149 Save your kit as a patch
- 182 Save your key commands as a set and back it up
- 183 Save your go-to plug-in chains as channel strip settings
- 186 Use Project Alternatives instead of Save As
- 194 Save a version before every major change
- 241 Back up the current version before you update
- 242 Back up your key commands and channel strip settings
- 243 Consolidate and archive your three most important projects
- 022 Copy your assets into the project so it travels
- 102 Reset all Flex edits rather than undoing repeatedly

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- 200 Adjust the Complexity slider before you adjust anything else [START HERE](#)
- 209 Show the Chord track in Global Tracks [START HERE](#)
- 213 Split any mixed audio into stems [START HERE](#)
- 217 Make an instrumental with one preset [START HERE](#)
- 224 Flashback Capture retrieves what you just played [START HERE](#)
- 195 Use Follow Rhythm Of to lock players together
- 196 Session Player performances are per region, so write in sections
- 197 Change style without losing your settings
- 198 Nudge Complexity or Intensity before you rebuild a part
- 199 Layer two Session Players on the same part
- 201 Shape the bass articulations in Details
- 202 Pair Bass Player with Studio Bass for its slides
- 203 Set the Bass Player to follow a specific track's rhythm
- 204 Use the left- and right-hand controls independently

- 205 Thin out the left hand without touching the right
- 206 Convert to MIDI, then thin out the part
- 207 Use Keyboard Player as a writing tool, not a final part
- 208 Try the Synth Player styles, not just piano
- 210 Generate chords from an existing region
- 211 Resize chords by dragging their lower edges
- 212 Use Pitch Source to keep parts off the Chord track
- 214 Use it on your own rough mixes, not just other people's records
- 215 Solo each stem and listen before you commit
- 216 Try single stems as layers first
- 218 Splitting adds rather than replaces
- 219 ChromaGlow is five saturation models in one plugin
- 220 Use Drive and Level Out together to stay level-matched
- 222 Use Bypass Below to keep the low end clean
- 223 Try it on the master at very low drive
- 225 MIDI capture works with the transport stopped
- 226 Check plug-in compatibility after updating
- 227 Synth Player lives inside Bass Player and Keyboard Player
- 228 Pick the Synth Keyboard style before you touch anything else
- 229 Synth Bass ships with three distinct characters
- 230 Shape the Pump Bass pump directly
- 231 Point Synth Player at a third-party synth
- 232 Chord ID reads chords off audio, not just MIDI
- 233 Check Chord ID's chords before you build on them
- 234 Everything downstream follows the Chord track
- 235 Run Chord ID on your own old bounces
- 236 Preview sound packs before you download them
- 237 Missing sounds after upgrading? Install the Legacy packs
- 238 Reanalyze and try each Character
- 239 Logic Pro 12 drops Intel Macs entirely
- 240 Never update in the middle of a paid project
- 241 Back up the current version before you update
- 242 Back up your key commands and channel strip settings
- 243 Consolidate and archive your three most important projects
- 244 Check your critical third-party plugins against the new version first
- 245 Note your current I/O and buffer settings
- 246 Update macOS and Logic separately, a week apart
- 247 Read the new Key Commands list for additions
- 248 Test your bounce path end to end before you need it
- 249 Give yourself a deliberate hour to explore
- 221 Try it before the compressor on the drum bus

START HERE

How to Use This Book

Do not read this front to back. Jump to the section that matches what you are stuck on right now, take the trick, and get back to the music. Every section is one click away from every page.

Each entry is short on purpose. Title, what it does, the key command. Ten seconds to read, yours for good.

-
- Every key command shown is the Logic Pro factory default on a US keyboard. If you have remapped anything, open Key Commands with `⌘K` and search the command name — the name is always given.
-
- Where a trick lives in a menu rather than on a key, the full menu path is written out, so it stays correct across versions.
-
- This edition covers Logic Pro 11 and 12. Earlier versions differ in ways that would make some of these wrong — 10.7 calls Settings “Preferences” and the View pane “Display”, among others — so it is not written for them.
-
- Every trick shows the source it was checked against — usually Apple's own Logic Pro guide — and the link is live, so you can read the original. Anything that could not be confirmed against a source was cut rather than printed on a guess. Tricks with no source are workflow habits, not claims about what Logic does.
-
- Tricks marked GAME CHANGER are the ones worth stealing first.
-
- Nothing here requires third-party plugins. It is all stock Logic.
-

The one habit that matters most

Every time you catch yourself doing something with the mouse for the third time, check whether it has a key command. If it does, learn it. If it does not, make one. That single habit is worth more than any individual trick in this book.

Key Legend

Logic's documentation and this book both use the Mac modifier symbols. If you are coming from another DAW, this is the page to bookmark.

	OPTION	⌘ (Option): Option-drag copies a region; Option-click a Solo button for an exclusive solo. ^{1,2}
	SHIFT	⇧ (Shift): Shift-click to add to a selection. ^{3,4}
	CONTROL	⌘ (Control): Control-click a selected region to open its shortcut menu. ⁵
	RETURN	↵ (Return): Sends the playhead to the start of the project. ^{6,7}
	DELETE	⌫ (Delete): Deletes the selected regions. ⁸
	SPACE	␣ (Space): Play / Stop. ^{9,10}

SOURCES 1 [Apple — Cut, copy, and paste regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 2 [Apple — Mute and solo channel strips in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 3 [Select parts of regions in Logic Pro for Mac - Apple Support](#) · 4 [Select regions in the Tracks area in Logic Pro - Apple Support \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · 5 [Apple — Use selection-based processing in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 6 [Apple — Control playback in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · 7 [studio-interns.com — Play from Beginning \(keyboard command of the day\)](#) · 8 [Apple — Delete regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 9 [Apple — Use transport key commands in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · 10 [macProVideo — 11 Essential Logic Pro X Shortcuts for Producers](#)

Three modifier rules that explain most of Logic

Hold ⌘ while dragging a region and you copy it instead of moving it. ⌘-click a channel's Volume fader and it returns to 0 dB. ⌘-click a Solo button and it becomes an exclusive solo — that channel alone.

SOURCE [Apple — Cut, copy, and paste regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Set channel strip volume in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Mute and solo channel strips in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

LEARN THESE FIRST

The Basic Key Commands

If you learn nothing else, learn this page. These are the commands you will use hundreds of times a day, and they are the foundation every other section builds on.

TRANSPORT

	Play / Stop ^{1,2,3}
	Go to beginning of project ^{3,4}
	Record ^{2,5,6}
	Cycle on / off ^{7,8}
	Discard recording, return to last play position ⁹
	Set locators around the selection, rounded to bars, and turn Cycle on ^{8,10,11}
	Open the Go to Position dialog ^{12,13}

SOURCES 1 [Apple — Use transport key commands in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · 2 [macProVideo — 11 Essential Logic Pro X Shortcuts for Producers](#) · 3 [studio-interns.com — Play from Beginning](#) · 4 [Apple — Control playback in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · 5 [Apple — Record sound from a microphone or instrument in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · 6 [Apple — Record to multiple audio tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 7 [Apple — Use the cycle area in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · 8 [Logic Studio Training Wiki — Locators](#) · 9 [Apple — Advanced recording commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 10 [macProVideo: 6 Logic Pro X Cycling Tips For A Faster Production Workflow](#) · 11 [studio-interns.com: Set Rounded Locators by Regions/Events \(keyboard command of the day\)](#) · 12 [macProVideo: 10 Logic Pro X Key Commands That Will Rock Your Workflow](#) · 13 [Logic Studio Training: Logic Pro X Arranging and Editing Tip: Go To Position](#)

WINDOWS AND VIEWS

X	Show / hide Mixer ^{1,2}
P	Show / hide Piano Roll ^{3,4}
E	Show / hide Editor ⁵
N	Show / hide Score Editor ⁶
Y	Show / hide Library ^{7,8}
O	Show / hide Loop Browser ^{9,10}
F	Show / hide Browsers ^{11,12}
B	Show / hide Smart Controls ¹³
I	Show / hide Inspector ^{9,10}
G	Show / hide Global Tracks ¹⁴
V	Show / hide all plug-in windows ^{15,16}

SOURCES 1 [Apple — Overview of mixing in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 2 [Apple — Logic Pro Mixer interface \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · 3 [Apple — Overview of the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 4 [macProVideo — 5 Essential Logic Pro X Piano Roll Tips](#) · 5 [Apple — Key commands for Main Window Tracks and Various Editors in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 6 [Apple — Key commands for Score Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 7 [macProVideo — Speed Up Your Workflow with Logic Pro X's Library](#) · 8 [Apple — Key commands for Library in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 9 [afteraudio — Key commands for Global Commands in Logic Pro \(copy of Apple table\)](#) · 10 [Apple — Key commands for Global Commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 11 [Studio Interns: Show/Hide Browsers F \(Logic Pro X keyboard command of the day\)](#) · 12 [macProVideo: 10 Logic Pro X Key Commands That Will Rock Your Workflow](#) · 13 [Apple — Overview of Smart Controls in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 14 [Apple — Show and hide global tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 15 [Why Logic Pro Rules: 10 Logic Pro X Key Commands That Will Rock Your Workflow](#) · 16 [Logic Studio Training: 7 Must-Know Logic Pro Shortcuts for Aspiring Beat Makers](#)

EDITING

⌘ Z	Undo ¹
⇧ ⌘ Z	Redo ¹
⌘ T	Split regions at the playhead ^{2,3}
⌘ R	Repeat regions or events ^{4,5}
⌘ A	Select all ^{6,7}
⇧ ⌘ A	Deselect all ^{7,8}
⌘ + DRAG	Copy a region instead of moving it ^{9,10,11}
⌘ + DRAG	Use your Command-click tool (Marquee is a popular choice) ¹²

SOURCES 1 [Apple — Undo and redo edits in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 2 [Studio Interns: Split Regions/Events at Playhead Position ⌘T \(keyboard command of the day\)](#) · 3 [Sound On Sound: Logic Pro Key Commands](#) · 4 [Sound On Sound - Logic Pro: Handling Repetition](#) · 5 [macProVideo - 10 Logic Pro X Key Commands That Will Rock Your Workflow](#) · 6 [Apple — Select events in the Logic Pro for Mac Event List](#) · 7 [Apple — Key commands for Global Commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 8 [Apple — Select tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 9 [Apple — Cut, copy, and paste regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 10 [Apple — Set channel strip volume in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 11 [Apple — Mute and solo channel strips in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 12 [Apple — Overview of tools in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

ZOOM AND NAVIGATION

 ⌘ + DRAG	Drag-zoom to any area ^{1,2}
--	--------------------------------------

SOURCES 1 [Apple — Zoom windows in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 2 [Why Logic Pro Rules — Speed Up Your Zooms in Logic Pro With These 2 Keys](#)

CAPTURE AND OUTPUT

 ↑ R	Flashback Capture — grab what you just played ^{1,2,3}
 ⌘ S	Save ^{4,5}
 ⌘ B	Bounce project or section ⁶
 ^ B	Bounce regions in place ^{7,8,9}
 ⌘ K	Open Key Commands ¹⁰
 ⌘ ,	Open Settings ¹¹

SOURCES 1 [Apple — Capture a recent audio performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 2 [Apple — Capture your most recent MIDI performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 3 [Logic Studio Training — Flashback Capture: Recover the Take You Forgot to Record](#) · 4 [Apple — Use project alternatives and backups in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 5 [Apple — Advanced settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 6 [Apple — Bounce a project to an audio file in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 7 [Why Logic Pro Rules: 10 Logic Pro X Key Commands That Will Rock Your Workflow](#) · 8 [Logic Studio Training: 7 Must-Know Logic Pro Shortcuts for Aspiring Beat Makers](#) · 9 [MusicTech: Logic's Bounce In Place function is essential](#) · 10 [Apple — Assign key commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · 11 [Apple — Overview of Logic Pro settings](#)

SECTION 01

Setting Up Logic.

Before a single note goes down, get the program out of your way. These are the settings worth checking on a fresh install, and each one says exactly where it lives.

29 TRICKS

AUDIO SETTINGS

001 **GAME CHANGER**

Run two buffer sizes, not one

Open Settings with , and go to Audio > Devices. Keep the I/O Buffer Size small while you track so monitoring latency stays low. Raise it when you mix: a larger buffer lowers the load on your Mac's CPU. A buffer too small for your Mac shows up as clicks, pops and crackles.

,

SOURCE [Apple — Configure audio devices to use with Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Overview of Logic Pro settings](#)

002

Set Processing Threads to Automatic

In Settings > Audio > Devices, Processing Threads is set to Automatic by default, and Apple recommends leaving it there. The one exception Apple names: set a thread count yourself when you run other CPU-intensive apps at the same time as Logic.

SOURCE [Apple — Configure audio devices to use with Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Avoid system overloads in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

003

Choose the right Multithreading mode

In Settings > Audio > Devices, the Multithreading pop-up offers two modes. Playback Tracks is the older behaviour: when several audio tracks record, or a Track Stack is selected for live input, all the input DSP runs on one thread and one core. Playback & Live Tracks spreads that load across threads but adds slightly more overall load. Use it only if you have demanding live tracks.

SOURCE [Apple — About the Multithreading setting in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Configure audio devices to use with Logic Pro for Mac](#)

004

Set Process Buffer Range to Large to avoid overloads

In Settings > Audio > Devices, Process Buffer Range sets the buffer Logic uses to compute mixes and effects. It is separate from the I/O buffer and offers Small, Medium and Large. Apple's advice for avoiding system overloads is to set it to Large.

SOURCE [Apple — Avoid system overloads in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Configure audio devices to use with Logic Pro for Mac](#)

005

Uncheck Software Monitoring if you monitor through your interface

If your audio interface supports hardware (direct) monitoring, turn off Software Monitoring in Settings > Audio > General. With it on, your input is processed in software and some latency is unavoidable. Apple's advice is to switch it off whenever you listen through your interface or mixing console.

SOURCE [Apple — General Audio settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — General Audio settings in Logic Pro for Mac \(IS locale\)](#)

RECORDING

006 **START HERE**

Leave Allow Quick Punch-In on

Apple's guide says Allow Quick Punch-In is on by default and recommends leaving it on: it lets you punch in and out of recording on the fly while the project keeps playing. Check it under Record > Allow Quick Punch-In, or Control-click the Record button in the control bar. Turn it off only if you record more tracks than there are channel strips (more than 128 in a new project) or your disk can't keep up.

SOURCE [Why Logic Pro Rules — Never Lose An Audio Take Again With Quick Punch-In](#) · [Why Logic Pro Rules — #16 Autopunch, Quick Punch-In, & Replace Recording Modes](#) · [Apple — Punch in and out of audio recordings in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

007

Make the bar and the beat click sound different

In the project settings, the Metronome pane controls the audio click, which comes from Klopfggeist, a virtual metronome sound source on the Click channel strip. Separate Note and Velocity fields set the note number and velocity of the notes generated for the bar, group, beat or division, so you can make the bar and the beat sound different. The Tone slider changes the sound from a short click to a pitched percussion sound like a wood block or claves. The Audio Click checkbox also works with any other plug-in you load on the Click channel strip.

SOURCE [Apple — Metronome project settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Klopfggeist in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

MIDI

008

Turn on scrubbing with audio in the Tracks area

Settings > Audio > Editing > "Scrubbing with audio in Tracks area". With it on, you can scrub audio regions in the Tracks area with the Scissors or Solo tool and find a spot by ear. Maximum Scrub Speed and Scrub Response fine-tune how it feels.

SOURCE [Apple — Audio Editing settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

009

Leave the MIDI Reset Messages at their defaults

Leave Logic's Reset Messages settings alone. Apple says Logic handles MIDI reset messages automatically and intelligently, so you can keep the defaults. The Control 123 (All Notes Off) and Control 121 (Reset Controls) options exist for compatibility with older MIDI devices. Switch one on only if an older synth needs it.

SOURCE [Apple — Reset Messages settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

010

Fix doubled notes from a controller

If notes double when you record from a keyboard synth, turn Local Off on the synth. If your keyboard has no Local Off setting, use Project Settings > MIDI > General > "Instrument Without MIDI Thru Function" and choose that instrument there. When a track assigned to it is selected, Logic does not pass your controller's MIDI through, which avoids the doubled notes.

SOURCE [Apple — General MIDI project settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

VIEW SETTINGS

011 **GAME CHANGER**

Turn on Enable Complete Features first

Go to Logic Pro > Settings > Advanced and select Enable Complete Features. It is one checkbox. Leave it off and advanced features stay hidden, including project alternatives and backups, beat mapping, and expanded mixing and automation.

SOURCE [Apple — Advanced settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

012

Colour regions individually, not by track

Choose Logic Pro > Settings > View, click Tracks, and set the Region Color pop-up to Individual instead of As Track Color. With Individual you can colour regions independently of their track, so you can colour-code by part. With As Track Color you cannot colour regions individually.

SOURCE [Apple — Tracks View settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Color regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

013 **START HERE**

Turn on “Show help tags”

In Logic Pro > Settings > View > General, select Show help tags. While you edit, help tags show the function name, the region or event name or number, the position and parameter values.

SOURCE [Apple — General View settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

GENERAL AND ADVANCED

014

Set Auto Set Locators to By Region Selection

Control-click the Cycle button in the control bar, click Auto Set Locators and choose By Region Selection. The locators and the cycle area are then set to the borders of the selected region.

SOURCE [Apple — Select parts of regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [macProVideo — 6 Logic Pro X Cycling Tips](#)

015 **GAME CHANGER**

Turn on “Limit Dragging to One Direction” in the Tracks area

Tick the “Limit Dragging to One Direction: In Tracks” checkbox in Logic Pro > Settings > General > Editing. Once you start a drag left or right, movement locks to the horizontal axis, so you cannot nudge a perfectly placed region onto another track by accident. To actually change tracks, let go, reselect, and drag up or down — or hold Shift to override the limit for one move. There is a matching checkbox for the Piano Roll and Score.

SOURCE [Apple — Move regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Move notes in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

016

Read the Clean Up list before you confirm it

File > Project Management > Clean Up always asks first and shows exactly what it will remove. Read the list — it deletes whole unused audio files, not just unused portions of them.

SOURCE [Apple — Clean up projects in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

PROJECT SETTINGS

017

Set your sample rate before you record, not after

Choose File > Project Settings > Audio and set the Sample Rate before you record or import anything. If an audio file's sample rate does not match the project's, it plays back at a different pitch. To have incoming files matched to the project rate, select "Convert audio file sample rate when importing" in File > Project Settings > Assets.

SOURCE [Apple — Set the sample rate of a project in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

018

Set the recording bit depth in Settings > Recording

Recording bit depth is set in Logic Pro > Settings > Recording. Match it to your audio device's bit depth. With 32-bit float, files are about 33% larger than 24-bit, but you can remove clipping just by lowering the region's gain.

SOURCE [Apple — Recording settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

019

GAME CHANGER

Turn on Smart Tempo "Keep Project Tempo" by default

In File > Project Settings > Smart Tempo, set the project tempo mode to Keep Project Tempo. In Keep mode Logic Pro maintains the project tempo when you record or import audio. Adapt Project Tempo changes the project tempo to match a recording or imported file, so use it only temporarily.

SOURCE [Apple — Choose the project tempo mode in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

020

Stop new recordings arriving pre-quantised

With no region selected, the Region inspector shows the defaults for new recordings. On an audio track its top line reads "Region: Audio Defaults" (Apple's guide calls these the Default Settings), and those values are applied to newly recorded regions. If new takes arrive quantised, check the Quantize value there and set it to Off. Capture the performance first; quantise as a decision.

SOURCE [Apple — Use the Region inspector in Logic Pro for Mac \(from prior audit, not re-retrieved\)](#)

021

Check Tuning when a synth sounds subtly off

Project Settings > Tuning sets the tuning for Logic's included software instruments. If a synth sounds subtly wrong against a sample, check here first: Equal Tempered turns off any alternative tuning, and the Tune slider should read A 440 Hz unless you meant to change it.

SOURCE [Apple — Tuning project settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

022

Copy your assets into the project so it travels

In File > Project Settings > Assets, select the copy checkboxes, such as "Copy audio files into project". The files are copied in the next time you save. From then on you can move or copy the project without losing any file references.

SOURCE [Apple — Manage project assets in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

DEFAULTS, TEMPLATES AND HOUSEKEEPING

023

GAME CHANGER

Save a Session Start template and set it as the default

Build one project with your usual tracks, buses, reverb and marker colours, then choose File > Save As Template. Then, in Project Handling settings, set the Startup Action pop-up to "Create New Project Using Default Template" and use the Default Template button to choose your template.

SOURCE [Apple — Project Handling settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

024

Save your starting channel strip as a setting

Build one channel strip the way you always start: your go-to EQ, compressor and sends. Click the Setting button at the top of the strip, choose "Save Channel Strip Setting as", pick a folder, name it and click Save. On any new track, load it from the Setting button's pop-up menu or from the Library.

SOURCE [Apple — Work with channel strip settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

025

Give each colour a fixed meaning

Press `⌘C` to open the Color palette (or Control-click a region and choose Name and Color > Show/Hide Colors), then click a colour. Decide once what each colour means to you (drums, vocals, keys, reference) and colour your template that way, so every project opens with the same language.

SOURCE [Apple — Color regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

026

Make a Project Alternative before big changes

File > Project Alternatives > New Alternative gives you another version of the project: name it and click Done. Make one before every big arrangement change. Alternatives need Enable Complete Features in Logic Pro > Settings > Advanced. File > Project Alternatives > Edit Alternatives lets you rename or delete them; you can't remove the Main alternative.

SOURCE [Apple — Use project alternatives and backups in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Advanced settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

027

START HERE

Hit `⌘S` often: every save banks a backup

Each time you save with File > Save (`⌘S`), Logic keeps a backup of the current project alternative, up to ten per alternative. To go back, choose File > Revert to and pick one; they're listed newest first. Backups need Enable Complete Features. Build the reflex of hitting `⌘S` every time you finish a thought.

 `⌘S`

SOURCE [Apple — Use project alternatives and backups in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Advanced settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

028

Move the Sound Library to an external drive on purpose

Logic Pro > Sound Library > Relocate Sound Library moves the library off your system drive: pick the drive or volume and click Relocate. Afterwards, don't rename that drive, or Logic Pro won't be able to find the Sound Library.

SOURCE [Apple Support - Relocate the Sound Library \(from prior audit, not re-retrieved\)](#)

029

Save the project as a Package so it travels

In the File > Save As dialog, choose "Organize my project as: Package" to save the project as a single file (package) containing its assets. Assets saved in the project are still there when you move or copy it. Choose Folder instead if you want a project folder with subfolders for each asset type.

SOURCE [Apple — Save Logic Pro for Mac projects](#)

SECTION 02

Arrangement Tricks.

Arranging is mostly moving big blocks of time around without breaking anything. These tricks let you restructure a whole song without dragging regions one by one.

14 TRICKS

MOVING TIME, NOT REGIONS

030

START HERE

GAME CHANGER

Use the Arrangement track to move whole sections

Open Global Tracks with G, enable the Arrangement track, and drop markers on your Verse, Chorus and Bridge. Now drag the Chorus marker and the entire section — every track, every automation point — moves with it.

G

SOURCE [Apple — Show and hide global tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Edit arrangement markers in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

031

START HERE

Drag one arrangement marker onto another to swap sections

Drag one arrangement marker directly over another and the two switch places, with all their content swapped. Every region, marker and automation point in each section goes with it, so you can try several song orders in moments.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit arrangement markers in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

032

START HERE

⌘-drag an arrangement marker to duplicate a section

Hold ⌘ and drag any arrangement marker to copy that entire section, contents and all, to a new point in the timeline.

⌘ + DRAG

SOURCE [Apple — Edit arrangement markers in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

033

START HERE

Delete a section and close the gap

Select the arrangement marker and press Delete once — that removes the section's regions. Press Delete again and the marker goes too, pulling everything after it back to close the hole.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit arrangement markers in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

034

Insert silence between the locators

Set the locators around the gap you want, then choose Edit > Cut/Insert Time > Insert Silence Between Locators. A region that crosses the left locator is cut there, and the part after it moves to the right of the right locator. It's a quick way to add two bars to an intro.

SOURCE [macProVideo — Making Whole Project Edits in Logic Pro](#) · [9to5Mac — Logic Pros: One-click Logic arrangement tricks](#) · [Apple — Add or remove gaps in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

035

Resize arrangement markers to fit your sections

New arrangement markers always appear at the start of the project or after the last existing marker, eight bars long, regardless of the playhead position. So create the marker first, then drag its right edge left or right until it matches the section.

SOURCE [Apple — Add arrangement markers in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

BUILDING AND DUPLICATING

036

Use aliases for parts that must stay identical

Option-Shift-drag a MIDI region to where you want the alias to start. An alias is a reference to the original region, so when you change the original, every alias changes too. Use it for a part that has to repeat identically across the song.

⌘⇧ + DRAG

SOURCE [macProVideo — Understanding Aliases in Logic Pro](#) · [Apple — Create MIDI aliases in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

037

Make a folder out of a section

Select every region in a section and choose Functions > Folder > Pack Folder from the Tracks area menu bar to pack them into a folder.

SOURCE [Apple — Pack and unpack folders in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

038

START HERE

GAME CHANGER

Colour-code sections, not instruments

Open the colour palette with `⌘C` and give every chorus the same colour across all tracks. You can then read the arrangement at a glance from fully zoomed out.

⌘C

SOURCE [Apple — Change the color of regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

JUDGING THE ARRANGEMENT

039

Use Track Stacks to collapse instrument families

Select related tracks, create a Track Stack and choose Summing Stack. All the tracks in a summing stack send their audio to one shared auxiliary track, so a whole drum kit sits under a single stack.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac track stacks overview](#) · [Logic Studio Training — How To Organize Your Logic Pro Projects With Folder Track Stacks](#)

040

Loop an arrangement section with one key

Select the regions that make up the section and press U (Set Rounded Locators by Regions/Events and Enable Cycle). Logic sets the locators around your selection, rounded to the nearest barlines, and turns Cycle on, so the section loops in time. Press `⌘U` instead to set the locators exactly at the selection's edges.

U

SOURCE [macProVideo — 6 Logic Pro X Cycling Tips For A Faster Production Workflow](#) · [studio-interns.com — Set Rounded Locators by Regions/Events \(keyboard command of the day\)](#) · [studio-interns.com — Set Locators/Loop by Regions/Events/Marquee and Enable Cycle/Loop ⌘U](#)

041

START HERE

Mute regions instead of deleting them while experimenting

Click a region with the Mute tool, or select the regions and press `Control-M`. Muted regions turn grey with a dot before the name, so arrangement experiments become reversible without touching undo.

⌘M

SOURCE [Apple — Mute and solo regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

042

START HERE

GAME CHANGER

Keep a “graveyard” track at the bottom

Make one muted, hidden track and drag every rejected idea onto it. Nothing is ever deleted, and the good version of that rejected idea is there when you need it three weeks later.

043

Use markers for notes to self, not just sections

The Marker track is one of the global tracks shown by default. Create a marker, then rename it “fix snare here” or “vocal comp needed”. Your to-do list lives on the timeline instead of on paper.

SOURCE [Apple — Show and hide global tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Rename markers in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 03

Navigating Tricks.

Getting the playhead and the view where you want them, instantly, is the difference between working and fiddling.

5 TRICKS

044 **START HERE****Drag-zoom to any area with $\text{⌘} + \text{⌘}$**

Hold $\text{⌘} + \text{⌘}$ and drag a box around any part of the arrangement to zoom straight to it. Hold $\text{⌘} + \text{⌘}$ and click empty space to zoom back out.

 $\text{⌘} + \text{⌘}$ + DRAGSOURCE [Apple — Zoom windows in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

045

Know what the number keys actually do

The number keys recall screensets, not markers — Apple's guide says you recall a screenset by pressing any numeric key except 0, so 1–9 switch window layouts. If you want marker jumps on a key, open Key Commands ($\text{⌘} + \text{K}$) and search “Go to Marker Number” — there are 20 of them, numbered by the order the markers appear in the project.

SOURCE [Apple — Create and recall screensets in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Navigate using markers in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Assign key commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

046

Scroll without the scrollbar

If your Mac has a trackpad that supports gestures, you can scroll and zoom the Tracks area with gestures instead of reaching for the scrollbars. On a Mac with a Touch Bar, swipe left or right on the Touch Bar to scroll through the visible area of the project.

SOURCE [Apple — Scroll and zoom in the Tracks area in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

047

Use the Cycle area as a bookmark

Select the region or passage you are working on and press U (Set Rounded Locators by Regions/Events and Enable Cycle). Logic sets the left and right locators around the selection, rounded, and turns Cycle on, so the cycle area marks your work area. Use $\text{⌘} + \text{U}$ instead if you want the locators set by the selection without rounding.

U

SOURCE [Apple — Key commands for Global Commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [studio-interns.com — Set Rounded Locators by Regions/Events \(keyboard command of the day\)](#) · [studio-interns.com — Set Locators/Loop by Regions/Events/Marquee and Enable Cycle/Loop \$\text{⌘} + \text{U}\$](#) · [afteraudio.com — Key commands for Global Commands in Logic Pro](#)

048

Toggle Catch to stop the screen running away

With Catch on, the visible section of a window follows the playhead during playback. For detailed editing, click the Catch button in the Tracks area (or editor) menu bar to turn it off, and the view holds still. If it keeps switching back on, check Logic Pro > Settings > General > Catch: “Catch when starting playback” and “Catch when moving playhead” re-enable it.

SOURCE [Apple — Control windows using Catch modes in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Catch settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 04

Composing MIDI Tricks.

Getting ideas out of your head and into the sequencer before they evaporate. These tricks are about speed of capture first and correctness second — you can always fix it later, but you cannot un-forget an idea.

13 TRICKS

CAPTURE WITHOUT A KEYBOARD

049

START HERE

GAME CHANGER

Capture the last thing you played, even when not recording

If you played something great without recording, press **⌘ R** (Flashback Capture) and Logic turns it into a region. MIDI can be captured whether the project is playing or stopped. Audio capture arrived in Logic 11.2: give the audio track focus and play the project. Logic saves audio only while there is an incoming signal, needs at least four seconds of playback, and keeps up to one minute.

⌘ R

SOURCE [Apple — Capture a recent audio performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Capture your most recent MIDI performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — What's new in Logic Pro for Mac 11.2](#) · [Logic Studio Training — Logic Pro 11.2 Update: Flashback Recording](#)

050

START HERE

Use the Step Input Keyboard for parts you cannot play

Choose Window > Show Step Input Keyboard to enter notes one at a time, setting each note's length and velocity with the Note Length and Velocity buttons.

SOURCE [Apple — Use step input recording techniques in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

051

START HERE

Draw notes with the Pencil, delete with the Eraser

The Pencil creates a note whose length, velocity and MIDI channel match the last note you created or edited. To remove a note, select it and press Delete, or click it with the Eraser tool. **⌘**-drag a note to copy it to a new position.

SOURCE [Apple — Add notes in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Delete notes in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Copy notes in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

CHORDS, SCALES AND HARMONY

052

GAME CHANGER

Use the Chord Trigger MIDI plugin to play chords with one finger

Insert Chord Trigger in the MIDI FX slot and click Learn. Click the trigger key you want on the upper keyboard first, then click the notes of the chord on the lower keyboard, then click Learn again to finish. Whole progressions become one-finger performances.

SOURCE [Apple — Use Chord Trigger in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Chord Trigger overview in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

053

Force everything into key with Transposer

Insert the Transposer MIDI FX and set its Root and Scale pop-up menus. Transposer transposes incoming MIDI notes in real time and corrects them to the selected scale, so you stay in key as you play. Choose User and click notes off on the on-screen keyboard to build your own scale.

SOURCE [Apple — Transposer in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

054

Use Arpeggiator to generate parts, then commit them

Insert Arpeggiator and dial in a pattern, then commit it with Bounce in Place. Logic renders the selected region, including all active plug-ins and automation data, to a 24-bit audio file at the project sample rate. The live pattern becomes a fixed part you can edit as audio.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac bounce in place overview](#) · [Apple — Bounce regions in place in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

055

Transpose without touching the notes

Select the regions and change Transpose in the Region inspector. Region parameters affect how regions play back but don't alter the data inside them, and every selected region changes together. If the project is playing, you hear the change immediately, so you can audition a new key and set it back to zero if it doesn't work.

SOURCE [Apple — Use the Region inspector in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Logic Studio Training — Master Region Editing with Logic Pro's Inspector Tools](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro MIDI region parameters \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

056

Use the Modifier MIDI plugin to reassign a controller

The Modifier MIDI plug-in reassigns or filters a single continuous controller or fader event. Choose or learn the incoming type in Input Event and the outgoing type in Re-Assign To, then use the Scale and Add sliders to scale or offset the output values.

SOURCE [Apple — Modifier in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

WORKING FAST WHILE IDEAS ARE HOT

057

Merge cycle takes to layer a part pass by pass

To build up a drum pattern one element per pass, set MIDI cycle recording to Merge: each pass of the cycle adds to the same region.

SOURCE [Apple — Recording settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

058

Freeze the instrument as soon as the part is done

Freeze the software instrument track once the part is done. Logic renders its instrument and effect plug-ins so they stop costing CPU, and unlike Bounce in Place, Freeze lets you return to the original track and its automation more easily. The trade-off: Apple notes that frozen instrument tracks can put more load on your disk, so if disk overload alerts start appearing, that is the likely cause.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac bounce in place overview](#) · [Apple — Freeze tracks in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Avoid system overloads in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

059

Commit a MIDI region to audio with Bounce in Place

Select the MIDI region and use Bounce in Place. Logic renders it through the instrument and all active plug-ins, plus automation data, to a 24-bit audio region at the project sample rate, which locks the idea in as audio.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac bounce in place overview](#) · [Apple — Bounce regions in place in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

060

Keep one “sketch” instrument track loaded at all times

Keep a piano patch on a permanently armed track so any idea can be captured right away. The moment capture takes effort, ideas stop arriving.

Use Note Repeat for hi-hats and rolls

In Step Sequencer, choose Note Repeat from the Edit Mode selector, then drag up on a hi-hat step to slice it into more repeats (1 to 16) or down for fewer. The inspector adds velocity ramp, velocity curve and Distribution for each step, so a roll can accelerate or decelerate instead of sitting flat.

SOURCE [Apple — Use Step Sequencer edit modes in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Edit Step Sequencer pattern, row, and step settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 05

Piano Roll Tricks.

The Piano Roll is where MIDI becomes music. These are the editing moves that make it fast.

13 TRICKS

SELECTING NOTES INTELLIGENTLY

062

START HERE

GAME CHANGER

Select all notes of the same pitch in one click

Click a key on the keyboard graphic at the left of the Piano Roll and every note at that pitch in the region is selected. Perfect for grabbing all the hi-hats at once.

SOURCE [Apple](#) — [Select notes in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

EDITING NOTES

063

GAME CHANGER

Change note length numerically in the Event Float

Open the Event Float window with Window > Show Event Float, or press `⌘E`. It shows the selected note as one line in the same format as the Event List, and you can type new values straight in, length included.

`⌘E`

SOURCE [Apple](#) — [Use the Event Float window in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Studio Interns](#) — [Show/Hide Event Float ⌘E, Logic Pro keyboard command of the day](#) · [Logic Pro GEM](#) — [Fader Event: A MIDI Event Wannabe](#)

064

Force legato to fix gappy pads

Select the notes, then choose Edit > Trim > Note End to Following Notes (Force Legato) in the Piano Roll. Every note extends to end where the next one begins, and pads and basslines stop sounding stuttery instantly.

SOURCE [9to5Mac](#) — [The Logic Pros: 3 helpful tricks to streamline your MIDI/audio editing](#) · [Your Local Musician](#) — [Logic Pro X Tutorial: Force Legato](#) · [Apple](#) — [Resize notes in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

065

Trim overlaps automatically

Select the notes and choose Edit > Trim > Note End to Remove Overlaps to Following Notes (8 Ticks Gap) in the Piano Roll. Logic shortens the note ends so nothing overlaps, leaving an eight-tick gap before the next note. A Selected Notes version does the same job measured only against the other selected notes.

SOURCE [Apple](#) — [Resize notes in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

066

⌘-drag a note to duplicate it

Hold `⌘` while dragging any note or selection to copy rather than move — you can even `⌘`-drag notes between two Piano Roll windows, or between two different projects. To stop a drag changing pitch, turn on Logic Pro > Settings > General > Editing > "Limit Dragging to One Direction In Piano Roll and Score": the direction you start in is then the only one you can move in. Pressing `↑` while dragging switches that behaviour on and off; it is not a pitch lock on its own. Apple's Logic Pro 12.2 release notes list a fix for Piano Roll notes not honoring this setting when dragged, so update if it seems to be ignored.

`⌘ + DRAG`

SOURCE [Apple](#) — [Copy notes in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple](#) — [Move notes in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple](#) — [Logic Pro for Mac release notes](#)

067

Place a note between grid divisions

Set the Snap pop-up menu to Ticks, which snaps to 1/3840 of a beat, or press Control-Shift as you drag to move the note in tick steps, overriding the Snap value. You can also switch snapping off with the On/Off button beside the Snap pop-up menu.

^ ↑ + DRAG

SOURCE [Apple — Snap items to the grid in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Move notes in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

VELOCITY AND EXPRESSION

068 GAME CHANGER

Change velocity by dragging with the Velocity tool

Pick the Velocity tool from the Tool menu, or hold Control-Command to turn the Pointer into it temporarily, then drag up or down on a note. A help tag shows the velocity as you drag. Choose View > Set Note Color > By Velocity if you want the note colour to track it too.

^ ⌘ (HOLD)

SOURCE [Apple — Edit velocity in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

069

Change a selection's velocity without flattening it

Select the notes, then drag one of them vertically with the Velocity tool, or drag the Velocity slider in the Piano Roll header. Logic keeps the relative differences between the notes' velocities. When any note hits 0 or 127, the rest stop too. Hold ⌘ while dragging to override this.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit velocity in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

070

Show the automation lane inside the Piano Roll

Click the Show/Hide Automation button in the Piano Roll Editor menu bar, then choose a parameter from the Automation/MIDI Parameter pop-up menu. Its MIDI or automation data appears in a lane under the notes, where you can edit it. Track automation shown there is the same curve as in the Tracks area, so edits appear in both places.

SOURCE [Apple — The Automation/MIDI area in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

071

Colour notes by velocity to read dynamics instantly

In the Piano Roll's View menu, set note colour to Velocity. Flat parts become visibly, obviously flat.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit velocity in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

072 **GAME CHANGER**

Quantise from the region inspector, not destructively

The Quantize field in the Region inspector is non-destructive and can be dialled back or removed at any point. Use it before you ever use the destructive version.

SOURCE [Apple — Quantize parameter values in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

073

Use Q-Strength to keep the human feel

Under the region's more-options triangle, Q-Strength at 60 to 80 percent pulls notes toward the grid without gluing them to it.

SOURCE [Apple — Advanced quantization parameters in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

074

Quantise only the notes that need it

Select the offending notes in the Piano Roll and quantise the selection rather than the whole region. The good parts of the take stay untouched.

SOURCE [Apple — Quantize the timing of notes in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

SECTION 06

Recording Audio Tricks.

These tricks are about getting a clean, usable, well-organised take the first time, and not losing a good performance to a technical mistake.

12 TRICKS

BEFORE YOU HIT RECORD

075

Aim your peaks at -12 to -18 dBFS

Aim for your loudest peaks to land between -12 and -18 dBFS. In 24-bit, recording hot won't improve the real-world noise performance. It just makes the track harder to mix against others recorded with sensible headroom.

SOURCE [Sound On Sound — Q. How much headroom should I leave with 24-bit recording?](#) · [Sound On Sound — Q. Should I gain-stage to -6dBFS or -18dBFS?](#)

076

GAME CHANGER

Track at the lowest I/O buffer your Mac can handle

Set the buffer before tracking, not during. In Logic Pro > Settings > Audio > Devices, choose the lowest I/O Buffer Size your Mac can handle. If you get system overload alerts, step it up one setting. Logic shows the resulting latency under the I/O Buffer Size menu, so judge by that readout, not the sample number.

SOURCE [Apple — Manage input monitoring latency in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

077

Turn on Low Latency Monitoring mode instead of disabling plug-ins one by one

Low Latency Monitoring mode bypasses the latency-inducing plug-ins that push a track past the Limit slider in Logic Pro > Settings > Audio > General (up to 30 ms). It also turns off that track's Aux sends, which kills a headphone reverb fed from a send. It affects only the focused instrument track and tracks with Input Monitoring or Record Enable on.

SOURCE [Apple — Work with plug-in latencies in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

078

Count-in and pre-roll are either/or — pick the right one

In the Recording project settings, the When Beginning buttons make you choose a count-in or a pre-roll. Count-in is set in bars or beats. Pre-roll is a playback time in seconds, up to 60. Use pre-roll when bars mean nothing (free-tempo material, dialogue) and count-in when you want the performer counted in musically.

SOURCE [Apple — Recording project settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

079

START HERE

GAME CHANGER

Name the track before you record, always

Regions that use the track name as their region name, and their source audio files, follow a default track name like "Audio 3". That name means nothing to you three months later.

SOURCE [Apple — Rename tracks in Logic Pro for Mac \(from prior audit; not re-retrieved this session\)](#)

080

START HERE

Record-enable multiple tracks at once

Click the Record Enable button in the track header of each track you want to record to — every armed button blinks red. Option-click is the escape hatch, not the shortcut: Option-clicking a track's Record Enable button makes it the only record-ready track, and Option-clicking a track that is already blinking red clears record-ready status across the whole project. Learn it as "solo the arm" and "disarm everything".

SOURCE [Apple — Record to multiple audio tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

WHILE RECORDING

081

START HERE

⌘. discards the take you just recorded

Press ⌘. — Discard Recording and Return to Last Play Position — to stop and throw away the take you just recorded, for when you know instantly it was not the one.

⌘.

SOURCE [Apple — Advanced recording commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

082

Watch the take list, not the waveform

The Take Folder pop-up menu in the upper-left corner of a take folder lists every take you've banked, and you can pick one from it during playback. If the performer is on take 14 and getting worse, that list is your cue to stop and move on.

SOURCE [Apple — Preview take recordings in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Create and save comps in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

083 **GAME CHANGER**

Build a dedicated headphone mix on a bus

Select every channel strip, choose a bus in a Send slot, and route the aux channel strip Logic creates to the output that feeds the headphone amp. Give the performer more of themselves and more reverb than you would ever put in the mix. Comfort produces better takes than accuracy does.

SOURCE [Apple — Send a mix to multiple destinations in Logic Pro for Mac](#) (from prior audit; not re-retrieved this session)

084

Use Input Monitoring rather than record enable to rehearse

The Input Monitoring (I) button in the track header lets you hear a track that isn't record-enabled, so you can set levels and practise the part before committing. On audio tracks it still involves some latency, depending on your hardware and driver settings.

SOURCE [Apple — Use input monitoring with tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

085

Turn off Software Monitoring when your interface can monitor

Software monitoring always carries some delay. Apple's advice when your interface supports hardware monitoring: turn off Software monitoring in Logic Pro > Settings > Audio > General, or with its control bar button.

SOURCE [Apple — General Audio settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Work with plug-in latencies in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

086 **START HERE**

Give the performer a click they can feel

Swap the metronome sound, add a bar accent, or better, program a simple drum loop. A musical reference beats a woodblock every time.

SOURCE [Apple — Metronome project settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 07

Editing Tips — Audio + MIDI.

The everyday editing moves in the Tracks area: selecting, trimming, splitting, joining and moving regions.

6 TRICKS

UNIVERSAL REGION COMMANDS

087

Trim to the playhead from either direction

The commands are “Set Region/Event/Marquee Start to Playhead Position” and the matching End command — search the Key Commands window for “Playhead Position” and put them on keys. (Note that on audio regions the Start command also moves the region anchor to the playhead.)

Related one-shot trims live under Edit > Trim, such as Region End to Next Region. No mouse precision needed.

SOURCE [Apple — Resize regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Create custom keyboard shortcuts for Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Studio Interns — Trim Region End to Next Region](#)

SNAP, GRID AND PRECISION

088

Use Snap Regions to Relative Value for off-grid parts

By default, Logic's Snap menu is set to Snap Regions to Absolute Value: a moved item snaps exactly to the nearest grid position. For a region that sits deliberately off-grid, choose Snap > Snap Regions to Relative Value in the Tracks area menu bar. It keeps its distance from the grid: a region at 2.1.1.16 moved one beat forward lands on 2.2.1.16, not 2.2.1.1.

SOURCE [Apple — Snap items to the grid in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

089 **START HERE**

T opens the Tool menu, T again closes it

Press T to open the Tool menu at the pointer — Apple's default key command for Show Tool Menu. Press T again to close it.

T

SOURCE [Apple — Key commands for Tool Menu in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Overview of tools in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

090

⌘ is your secondary tool

Logic has two Tool menus: Left-click and Command-click. Choose a tool from the Command-click Tool menu, then hold ⌘ to use it. Let go and you are back on your Left-click tool. The Command-click Tool menu only appears when Enable Complete Features is on, in Logic Pro > Settings > Advanced.

SOURCE [Apple — Overview of tools in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Assign tools in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Use the complete set of features in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

091 **START HERE**

Select everything after this point in one keystroke

Press ⌘ F (Select All Following) to select everything that comes after the current selection. That puts you one keystroke from moving the rest of the song.

⌘ F

SOURCE [Apple — Key commands for Main Window Tracks and Various Editors in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Select events in the Logic Pro for Mac Event List](#) · [studio-interns.com — Select All Following ⌘ F](#) · [studio-interns.com — Select All Following of Same Track/Pitch ^ ⌘ F](#)

092

Lock events so tempo changes cannot move them

Lock SMPTE Position keeps events at their absolute time when you change the tempo later. In the Event List, select events and choose Functions > Lock SMPTE Position, or Control-click and choose it from the shortcut menu; a padlock appears in the Lock column. Lock a region and every event inside it is locked. It requires Enable Complete Features in Logic Pro > Settings > Advanced.

SOURCE [Apple — Protect the position of events in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 08

Audio Editing Tricks.

Comping, crossfades, timing and pitch — where a good take becomes a great one.

15 TRICKS

COMPING TAKES

093

Put take-switching on keys you choose

Press `⌘K` to open the [Key Commands](#) window and type "Take" in the search field. Find [Select Previous Take or Comp](#) and [Select Next Take or Comp](#), which step through the takes and comps listed in the take folder's pop-up menu. Check what they are assigned to, and put them on keys you can reach while you audition.

`⌘K`

SOURCE [Apple — Assign key commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Create custom keyboard shortcuts for Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Preview take recordings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

094

Save your comp as a new comp before changing it

The [take folder menu](#) has "Duplicate Comp". Do this before every significant change and you can always go back to the version that was working.

SOURCE [Apple — Create and save comps in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

095

Move a comp edit point without redoing the comp

Drag the vertical divider between two [take](#) sections to slide the edit point earlier or later.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit comps in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

FADES AND CLICKS

096

Curve the fade after you draw it

With the [Fade tool](#), hover over the middle of a fade you've made and drag left or right to change its curve. Or select the [region](#) and adjust the fade's Curve value in the [Region inspector](#).

SOURCE [Why Logic Pro Rules - How to Get the Most Out of Logic Pro X's Fade Tool](#) · [Apple — Edit fades in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

097 **GAME CHANGER**

Use "Remove Silence from Audio Region" on a live kit or spoken word

Select the [audio region](#) and press `⌘X` (Remove Silence from Audio Region). Everything below a threshold you set is removed, and new regions are created from what remains. That makes it useful for a live kit or spoken word.

`⌘X`

SOURCE [studio-interns.com — Remove Silence from Audio Region... ⌘X](#) · [9to5Mac — Editing noisy audio files with Remove Silence in Logic Pro X](#) · [Apple — Uses for Remove Silence in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

098

Stop clicks at region starts with a short fade

Audio that starts abruptly can click. A short [fade-in](#) gives it a gradual ramp and prevents the click. When you trim or split in the Audio Track Editor, turn on [Snap to Zero Crossings](#) as well, so the edit lands where no click is produced.

SOURCE [Why Logic Pro Rules — How to Get the Most Out of Logic Pro X's Fade Tool](#) · [Apple — Snap to zero in the Logic Pro for Mac Audio Track Editor](#)

TIMING AND PITCH

099

Add flex markers either side before you move one

Placing anchor markers on the neighbouring transients stops your edit from stretching the whole bar.

SOURCE [Apple — Flex tool time stretching in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

100

Quantise audio with Flex enabled

Give the audio track a Flex mode and make sure Flex is selected for the region in the Region inspector. You can then quantize that audio by choosing a value from the Quantize pop-up menu in the Region inspector. It's real-time, so you can change the value later, or turn it off to get the original timing back.

SOURCE [macProVideo - Quantizing In Logic: The Essentials](#) · [Sound On Sound - Logic Pro: Editing Drum Timings](#) · [Apple — Quantize regions in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

101

Use Flex Pitch to fix a single flat note

Switch the track's Flex mode to Flex Pitch, then drag the note blob vertically. The gain, vibrato, pitch drift and formant handles are all on the same blob.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit pitch and timing with Flex Pitch in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

102

Reset all Flex edits rather than undoing repeatedly

Control-click the flexed region and choose Reset All Flex Edits. It clears the region's flex data and starts you fresh.

SOURCE [Apple — Delete, reset and move flex markers in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

DESTRUCTIVE AND FILE-LEVEL EDITING

103

Use the Audio File Editor for true destructive edits

Double-click a region and switch to the File tab. Silence, reverse, normalise and pencil-edit at the sample level. Changes here affect the file itself.

SOURCE [Apple — Audio File Editor overview in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

104

Change region level non-destructively with Gain

The Region inspector's Gain parameter changes playback level without touching the file. Always try this before normalising.

SOURCE [Apple — Change gain of audio regions in the Tracks area \(Logic Pro for Mac\)](#)

105

Reclaim disk space with Project Management > Clean Up

Once your comps are final, choose File > Project Management > Clean Up. Its options are Delete Unused Audio Files, Delete Unreferenced Audio Files and Delete Backups, and files are deleted from disk. A dialog lists everything to be deleted, so deselect the Delete checkbox for anything you want to keep, and back up first.

SOURCE [Apple — Clean up Logic Pro for Mac projects](#) · [Apple — Remove unused audio files in your Logic Pro for Mac project](#)

106

Reverse a region, destructively or not

Select the region, then Functions > Reverse in the Audio File Editor, or apply the Reverse setting in the region inspector for a non-destructive version.

SOURCE [Apple — Reverse audio regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Commit edits with Bounce Regions in Place

When you are happy with a comp, select the regions and choose File > Bounce > Regions in Place. In the dialog, set the name and a Destination: New Track, or Selected Track to replace the regions. Set Source to Leave, Mute or Delete, and decide whether to Bypass Effect Plug-ins. Choose Leave or Mute to keep the original.

SOURCE [Apple — Bounce regions in place in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 09

Marquee Tool Tricks.

The Marquee tool selects a range of time rather than whole regions, across one track or many. Once that clicks, a lot of editing you would otherwise do by hand becomes unnecessary.

SOURCE [Apple — Select parts of regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

6 TRICKS

108

START HERE

GAME CHANGER

Make Marquee your ⌘-click tool

Make Marquee your Command-click tool. In the Tracks area, click the Command-click Tool menu and choose the Marquee tool. From then on, hold ⌘ and drag to marquee-select parts of regions on one or more tracks. Release ⌘ and you're back on your Left-click tool. The Command-click Tool menu only appears when Enable Complete Features is on, in Logic Pro > Settings > Advanced.

⌘ + DRAG

SOURCE [Apple — Overview of tools in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Select parts of regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Sound On Sound — Marquee Of Distinction](#) · [Apple — Assign tools in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Use the complete set of features in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

109

START HERE

Play just the marquee selection

Start playback while a marquee selection is active and Logic plays from the selection's left edge to its right edge, then stops. It's the fastest way to audition a specific range without touching the locators.

SOURCE [Apple — Select parts of regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

110

START HERE

Cut a hole in every track at once

Choose View > Marquee Ruler, then drag in the marquee ruler to select across all tracks. Delete, and only the parts of regions inside the marquee are removed, on every track, in one action.

SOURCE [Apple — Select parts of regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

111

Set the locators to the marquee instantly

With a marquee selection active, press ⌘U (Set Locators/Loop by Regions/Events/Marquee and Enable Cycle/Loop). The cycle locators snap to the selection and Cycle turns on. Prefer the mouse? Control-click the marquee ruler and choose Set Locators by Selection and Enable Cycle.

⌘ U

SOURCE [studio-interns.com — Set Locators/Loop by Regions/Events/Marquee and Enable Cycle/Loop](#) · [macProVideo — 11 Essential Logic Pro X Shortcuts for Producers](#) · [Apple — Select parts of regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

BEYOND SELECTION

112

Marquee automation to move only that range

With automation showing, drag a marquee across part of an automation lane, then click inside the selection. Logic creates two automation points at each edge, so you can drag that section up or down without changing anything on either side. Apple lists this under Enable Complete Features (Logic Pro > Settings > Advanced).

SOURCE [Apple — Select parts of regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Why Logic Pro Rules — Logic Pro X Automation](#) · [Apple — Add and adjust automation points in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Use the complete set of features in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

113

Use marquee to create a drop

Drag in the marquee ruler across the bar before a chorus to select it on every track, then delete. You get clean, arrangement-wide silence for that bar in one edit.

SOURCE [Apple — Select parts of regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 10

Automation Tricks.

Automation is what separates a static mix from a moving one. Logic has two kinds: track automation stays tied to its place on the timeline, while region automation travels with its region. Knowing which one you are in explains most automation surprises.

SOURCE [Apple — Track automation vs. region automation in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

13 TRICKS

THE TWO SYSTEMS

114

Use Region automation for anything that belongs to the part

A filter sweep that is part of a synth riff should move with the riff. Region automation does that; track automation does not.

SOURCE [Apple — Track automation vs region automation in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

115

START HERE

Press A to toggle automation view

Press A to show or hide track automation. In the Audio Track Editor it does the same job as the Show/Hide Automation button.

A

SOURCE [Apple — Automation in the Logic Pro for Mac Audio Track Editor](#) · [Apple — Show automation curves in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Why Logic Pro Rules — Logic Pro X Automation](#)

WRITING AUTOMATION

116

GAME CHANGER

Use Latch mode for almost everything

Latch writes while you move the control and holds the last value when you let go. Touch snaps back, Write erases as it goes, and Read plays only. Latch is the right default.

SOURCE [Apple — Choose automation modes in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

117

Never leave a track in Write mode

Write mode erases existing automation as the playhead passes, whether you touch the fader or not.

SOURCE [Apple — Choose automation modes in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

118

START HERE

Delete an automation point without dragging it

Double-click the point, or select it and press Delete, or drag across it with the Eraser.

SOURCE [Apple — Delete automation in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

119

START HERE

Curve an automation line with ^ ↑ -drag

Hold ^ ↑ and, with the Pointer tool, drag the line between two automation points to bend it into a curve. This works as long as the two points aren't directly above each other.

^ ↑ + DRAG

SOURCE [macProVideo - 5 Automation Power-User Tips and Tricks in Logic Pro](#) · [Sound On Sound - Fine-tuning Automation In Logic](#) · [Apple — Select, copy, and move automation in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

120

Trim existing automation up or down

Trim is not a mode on its own. It works in combination with Touch or Latch. With it on, moving the fader offsets existing automation up or down by the amount you move it. It applies only to Volume, Pan and Send levels, so use it to lift an already-automated vocal without redrawing its moves.

SOURCE [Apple — Choose automation modes in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

121

Use Relative mode to layer a second pass

Relative automation sits on top of your existing pass as an offset, so you can add a ride without destroying the original moves.

SOURCE [Apple — Choose automation modes in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

1 2 2 **GAME CHANGER**

Marquee a range, then drag the line to change only that section

Drag across the bars you want to change with the Marquee tool, then drag the automation line inside that selection. Logic creates two automation points at the left edge and two at the right edge of the selection, so the change stays boxed in and does not bleed into the surrounding bars.

SOURCE [Apple — Select parts of regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

1 2 3

Show several automation lanes at once

Instead of switching one automation curve between parameters, show automation sub-lanes, which appear below the main track. Click the automation sub-lane disclosure triangle, then choose each lane's parameter from its Automation Parameter pop-up menu. You can then see several parameters at once.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac release notes](#) · [Apple — Overview of automation in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Show automation curves in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

1 2 4

Delete all automation on a track in one command

Choose Mix > Delete Automation > Delete All Automation on Selected Track to remove every automation parameter from that track at once. The same submenu has Delete Visible Automation on Selected Track, which removes only the active parameter, and Delete Orphaned Automation on Selected Track. Automation can become orphaned when it is copied between tracks.

SOURCE [Apple — Delete automation in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

1 2 5

Thin dense automation after recording a controller pass

Delete Redundant Automation Points cleans up heavy controller passes, but it is global: it removes redundant points on all regions and all tracks, not just your selection. To thin one passage only, select the points in that range and press Delete, then redraw.

SOURCE [Apple — Delete automation in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [studio-interns — Delete Redundant Automation Points](#)

1 2 6

Snap automation to the grid when it needs to be rhythmic

Open the Snap pop-up menu in the Tracks area, choose Snap Automation, and pick a value from the submenu. Automation edits then snap to that value, so filter stabs land on the grid. You can set it independently in the Tracks area and the Piano Roll Editor.

SOURCE [Apple — Snap automation to grid position in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 11

Step Sequencer Tricks.

The Step Sequencer is more than a drum grid. Each row can have its own length, step rate, playback mode and start offset, so rows can drift against each other in ways a fixed grid never will.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit Step Sequencer pattern, row, and step settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

11 TRICKS

127 **GAME CHANGER****Give every row a different step rate**

Rows do not have to share the pattern's step rate. Click a row header to select the row, then in the Step Sequencer inspector click Row and choose a note value from the Step Rate pop-up menu. To change just one step, switch to Step Rate edit mode and drag vertically in that step. Hats at 1/16 and kick at 1/8 each run at their own speed.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit Step Sequencer pattern, row, and step settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Edit Step Sequencer rows in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Use Step Sequencer edit modes in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Change the musical length of a pattern in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

128

Use the row's Playback Mode for variation

Forward, Backward, Ping-Pong, Pendulum, Wander, Shuffle and Random: set one for the whole pattern, or a different one per row. Set just the hats to Random and their step order becomes completely random and nonlooping while the kick stays put.

SOURCE [Apple — Modify pattern playback in Step Sequencer in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Edit Step Sequencer pattern, row, and step settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

129

Increase pattern length beyond 16 steps

The Step Sequencer supports up to 64 steps per pattern. Longer patterns mean fewer copies and more room for fills.

SOURCE [Apple — Change the musical length of a pattern in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

PER-STEP EDITING

130

Use Note Repeat for rolls without drawing them

Set a step's repeat value to 4 and it fires four times inside that step. Instant trap hats, no extra steps required.

SOURCE [Apple — Use Step Sequencer edit modes in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

131

Use Gate to shorten hits and Tie to lengthen them

Gate sets a step's note length as a percentage of the step, shortening it to less than the step's full duration — short gates on a bass pattern give you staccato stabs. It only ever shortens; to make a note run longer than its step, switch to Tie edit mode and click the right edge of the step to tie it to the following one, which lengthens its duration by the value of the step it is tied to. Both are per-step, not per-pattern.

SOURCE [Apple — Use Step Sequencer edit modes in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

132

Tie steps together for sustained notes

Tie mode joins consecutive steps into one long note, which is how you write bass and lead lines rather than just percussion.

SOURCE [Apple — Use Step Sequencer edit modes in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

133

Clear a step to reset all its edit-mode values

Over-edited a step? Shift-click it to select it, then choose Functions > Clear Step from the Step Sequencer menu bar. That resets all of the step's edit-mode values to their defaults in one move — for step rate, the default is the row's step rate. You can also clear a whole row or the whole pattern.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit Step Sequencer steps in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

134

Use the Step Sequencer on any software instrument

It is not a drum tool. Put it on a synth, switch the rows to pitches, and you have a hardware-style note sequencer.

SOURCE [Apple — Overview of Step Sequencer in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

136

Build a library of pattern regions

Save patterns through the Pattern Browser, or keep a muted track of favourites at the bottom of a template project.

SOURCE [Apple — Load and save patterns in Step Sequencer in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

135 **GAME CHANGER**

Automate plugin parameters per step

Add a row and assign it to any automatable plugin parameter. Now you can sequence filter cutoff step by step alongside the notes.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit Step Sequencer rows in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

137

Use Skip and Loop Start/End to reshape a row

Skip drops a step from playback: the sequencer moves straight to the next step, which shortens the row by that step's length. Loop Start/End sets where the row cycles.

SOURCE [Apple — Use Step Sequencer edit modes in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Edit Step Sequencer pattern, row, and step settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 12

Logic Drummer Tricks.

Drummer is not a loop library. It plays a performance you can steer, and its kick and snare can follow the rhythm of another track in your project — a different one for each region if you like.

SOURCE [Apple — Follow rhythm of chords and other tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

6 TRICKS

GETTING A REAL PERFORMANCE

138

Use Complexity and Intensity, then the kit-piece sliders

In the Session Player Editor, drag the Complexity slider up for a busier part and the Intensity slider up for a louder one. Apple lists both as settings common to all Session Players, Drummer included. Then click Details and drag the kit piece sliders to set the complexity range of individual kit pieces.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit a Session Player performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Logic Pro Help — Logic Pro 11 new features explained](#)

139

Change the drummer, not just the preset

If a preset is close but the feel is wrong, try other presets or drummers. Lock the fills first if you like them: Apple says the lock stops 'any changes to the fills setting when switching presets or drummers.'

SOURCE [Apple — Edit a Drummer performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Session Players overview in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

140

START HERE

Turn individual kit pieces on and off per region

Click a kit piece in the editor to enable or disable it for that region only. Drop the crash out of the verse and back in for the chorus.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit a Drummer performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

TAKING CONTROL

141

START HERE

GAME CHANGER

Convert a Drummer region to MIDI and edit it by hand

Right-click the region and choose Convert > Convert to MIDI Region. You get the full performance in the Piano Roll to nudge, delete and re-velocity as you like.

SOURCE [Apple — Convert Session Player regions into MIDI or pattern regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

142

Use the Details panel for feel, ghost notes and hi-hat

Click the Details button in the Drummer Editor to reveal Feel (drag right to play ahead of the beat, left to play behind it), Ghost Notes (syncopated snare and kick hits), Hi-Hat openness and Humanize. This is where a stiff pattern becomes a groove.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit a Drummer performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

143

Swap and tune kit pieces in Drum Kit Designer

In Drum Kit Designer, click a kit piece to open its Edit and Exchange panes. Swap the kick or snare (toms, cymbals and hi-hat too on multi-channel kits) and set Tune, Dampen (sustain) and Gain per piece. Multi-channel kits add Overheads and Room (A, B or off) switches.

SOURCE [Apple — Drum Kit Designer Edit pane in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Use Drum Kit Designer in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Get started with Drummer in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 13

Drum Machine Designer Tricks.

Drum Machine Designer is built on a Track Stack: every pad you fill gets its own subtrack and channel strip, so each drum sound can be processed on its own in the Mixer.

SOURCE [Apple — Drum Machine Designer in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

6 TRICKS

BUILDING THE KIT

144 GAME CHANGER

Drag any audio file straight onto a pad

Drag a WAV, AIFF or MP3 from the Finder or a Logic Pro browser, or a region from the Tracks area, onto a pad to add it to your kit. When you drop a region onto a pad, Drum Machine Designer inserts a new Quick Sampler instance on a new subtrack.

SOURCE [Apple — Create and customize Drum Machine Designer kits in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

145 GAME CHANGER

Every pad is its own channel strip

Open the Mixer with X and you will see each pad as a separate channel inside the stack. Compress the snare, saturate the kick, send only the claps to reverb.

X

SOURCE [Apple — Create and customize Drum Machine Designer kits in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Overview of mixing in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

146 START HERE

Copy a pad with Control-click

To copy a pad, Control-click it and choose Copy. Then Control-click the pad you want to replace and choose Paste. Cut works the same way. Dragging a pad to an empty location in the grid reorders it rather than copying it.

SOURCE [Apple — Use Drum Machine Designer pad controls in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

147

Use Pad Controls for quick shaping

Select a pad and click Pad Controls in the bar below the grid. The pad's tone and effect parameters appear in the Plug-in pane. For Quick Sampler pads, Q-Sampler Main shows the waveform editor and Q-Sampler Details shows the LFOs and the pitch, filter and amp envelopes. Drum Synth pads get a Drum Synth button.

SOURCE [Apple — Drum Machine Designer pad controls bar in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Use Drum Machine Designer pad controls in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

MIXING AND PERFORMING

148

Use the main track for the whole kit

A Drum Machine Designer kit is a track stack. Plug-ins on its main track affect every subtrack, so put your kit compressor and limiter there. Any pad whose output you route outside the stack skips that processing.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac track stacks overview](#) · [Apple — Create and customize Drum Machine Designer kits in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

149

Save your kit as a patch

In Drum Machine Designer, select the kit name pad at the top so you save the complete kit, then click Save at the bottom of the Library. A summing-stack patch can include the main track and all subtracks, along with their channel strip and plug-in settings.

SOURCE [Apple — Copy a custom Drum Machine Designer kit to another Mac](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac track stacks overview](#)

SECTION 14

Quick Sampler Tricks.

Quick Sampler turns any sound into a playable instrument — the short route from “that noise is interesting” to “that noise is now a bassline”.

7 TRICKS

LOADING AND SLICING

150

Know the four modes and pick deliberately

Classic plays the sample while you hold a key, the way to play a sound across the keyboard. One Shot plays from start marker to end marker on each note, good for drum loops and effects. Slice chops a sample into slices mapped to keys. Recorder captures live input as an audio recording.

SOURCE [Apple — Choose a Quick Sampler mode in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

151

GAME CHANGER

Use Slice mode with Transient detection on any break

Load a drum loop, switch to Slice, choose Transient from the Mode pop-up menu, and each slice is mapped to its own key. Drag from the lower part of the waveform display to a software instrument track in the Tracks area to get the MIDI — the original groove, fully rearrangeable.

SOURCE [Apple — Quick Sampler Slice mode in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Choose a Quick Sampler mode in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

152

Drag audio directly from the Tracks area into a loaded Quick Sampler

Drag a region into Quick Sampler's waveform display to swap the sound. Drop it on Original to keep the file's own tuning, loudness, looping and length. Drop it on Optimized and Quick Sampler optimizes tuning, loudness and length, and adds loop and crossfade markers to rhythmic or looped material. The region is bounced offline first. Dragging to the track header instead opens the Replace existing sound dialog.

SOURCE [Apple — Add audio to Quick Sampler in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Drag and drop to create sampler instrument tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SHAPING THE SOUND

153

Use Flex and Follow Tempo to lock a loop to the project

Flex and Follow Tempo are separate buttons at the lower right of the waveform display in Classic, One Shot and Slice modes. Flex alone plays the sample at its original speed on every key: the pitch changes, the speed doesn't. Turn on Follow Tempo as well and playback syncs to the project tempo, with slices stretching or contracting to match.

SOURCE [Apple — Use Flex in Quick Sampler in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

154

Set the root key correctly or nothing will be in tune

The root key is the note that plays your sample at its original pitch; keys above and below transpose it up or down. If a sample plays out of tune across the keyboard, open the Pitch controls and set the Root Key pop-up menu to the note the sample actually is.

SOURCE [Apple — Quick Sampler Pitch controls in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

155 **GAME CHANGER**

Shuffle the slice MIDI to rearrange the break

The generated MIDI plays the slices in the original order. Now shuffle the notes and the break rearranges itself.

SOURCE [Apple — Quick Sampler Slice mode in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Choose a Quick Sampler mode in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

156

Convert Quick Sampler to Sampler for full control

Replace Quick Sampler with Sampler on the instrument channel strip and your current content transfers automatically. Do it when you need to work with more than one audio file at a time. It is a one-way trip: Sampler can load Quick Sampler settings, but Quick Sampler cannot open a Sampler setting.

SOURCE [Apple — Quick Sampler overview in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 15

Mixer Tricks.

The Mixer is where a collection of good parts becomes a record. These are the organisational and workflow tricks — the ones that stop a 60-track session from becoming unmanageable.

10 TRICKS

GETTING AROUND THE MIXER

157 **START HERE**

X shows and hides the Mixer

Press X (View > Show Mixer) to show and hide the Mixer in the main window, so you can flip between arrangement and mixer with one key. If you want the Mixer in its own window instead, press Command-2 (Window > Open Mixer).

X

SOURCE [Apple — Key commands for Global Commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Overview of mixing in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

158 **START HERE** **GAME CHANGER**

⌘-click a fader to reset it to 0 dB

Option-click a channel strip's Volume fader to snap it back to 0 dB. It's the fastest way to undo a level you've talked yourself into.

⌘ + CLICK

SOURCE [Apple — Set channel strip volume in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

159

⌘-click Solo for exclusive solo

Option-clicking an unsoloed channel strip solos it and unsolos every other channel strip — one gesture to hear one thing. Option-clicking any active Solo button clears all solos at once. Mute has its own bulk gesture, using Command rather than Option: Command-click a Mute button and every Mute button currently in the same state flips with it, including the output and master strips.

⌘ + CLICK

SOURCE [Apple — Mute and solo channel strips in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

ROUTING AND ORGANISATION

160 **GAME CHANGER**

Use VCA faders for level groups without changing routing

A VCA changes the volume of each channel assigned to it without routing their audio through an aux, so nothing gets re-patched. One consequence: with post-fader sends, what each member sends to an effect follows the VCA, so pulling the VCA down pulls its reverb and delay sends down too, keeping the dry/wet balance. Use Pre Fader sends for anything that must stay constant.

SOURCE [Apple — Use VCA groups in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [macProVideo - VCA Groups and Faders in Logic Pro X: What, Why, and How?](#)

161

Use Summing Stacks for processing groups

Select tracks and hit ⌘⇧D, then choose Summing Stack in the dialog that appears. Everything routes to one aux you can compress and EQ as a unit.

⌘⇧D

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac track stacks overview](#) · [Apple — Create and edit Track Stacks in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

162

Create a send and Logic makes the aux for you

Click a channel's Send slot and choose a bus. Logic creates the aux channel strip automatically, with that bus already set as its input — unless the bus is already in use as an input on another channel strip.

SOURCE [Apple — Send signals to multiple destinations in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Overview of aux channel strips in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

163

Set sends to pre-fader for headphone mixes and effects that must stay constant

Every send has three signal-flow modes, set from the send's pop-up menu: Post Pan (after fader and pan), Post Fader (follows volume but not pan) and Pre Fader (affected by neither). Use a post mode for reverb, so the effect tracks the part. Use Pre Fader for a headphone cue mix, or any send that must stay put while you ride the fader.

SOURCE [Apple — Route audio via send effects in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Why Logic Pro Rules - Pre-Fader vs Post-Fader vs Post-Pan Explained](#)

164

Colour your tracks and the mixer follows

Mixer channels take the track colour. A consistent colour scheme means you find the vocal bus without reading a single label.

SOURCE [Apple — Change track colors in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Channel strip controls in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

PLUGINS IN THE MIXER

165

START HERE

Bypass with ⌘-click, browse with the slot arrows

⌘-click an insert slot to bypass the plugin without opening it. To browse plugins, click the arrows at the right edge of the slot.

⌘ + CLICK

SOURCE [Apple — Add, remove, move and copy plug-ins in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

166

Drag plugins between insert slots and between channels

Reorder your chain by dragging a plug-in up or down, or drag it to another channel strip to move it there. Hold ⌘ and drag it to an unused slot to copy rather than move.

SOURCE [Apple — Add, remove, move and copy plug-ins in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 16

Logic's Built-in Plugins.

The stock plugins worth knowing properly, and the specific controls that make each one worth reaching for.

14 TRICKS

DYNAMICS

167

Compressor — use the side-chain filter before reaching for a multiband

Turn on the side-chain filter, set it to HP and sweep the frequency up until the kick stops triggering most of the gain reduction. Click Listen to hear what the detector hears. Switch Listen off again before you judge the mix.

SOURCE [Apple — Compressor side chain parameters in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Sound On Sound — Logic: Compression Sessions](#) · [MusicTech — Advanced Use Of The Logic Compressor](#)

168

Multipressor — use it to control one problem band only

Bypass every band except the one you need. It becomes a dynamic EQ rather than a mix-flattening machine.

SOURCE [Apple — Multipressor in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Multipressor frequency band controls in Logic Pro for Mac \(MY\)](#)

169

Noise Gate — use the side chain to key one sound from another

Gate a white noise layer from the snare's signal and you have an instant layered snare that follows the performance.

SOURCE [Apple — Use Noise Gate in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

170

Enveloper — reshape a transient without a compressor

The two Gain sliders either side of the display boost or cut the attack and release phases of any sound. Push Attack up to add snap to a soft kick. Pull it down and percussive sounds fade in more softly.

SOURCE [Apple — Enveloper in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

EQ AND TONE

171

Channel EQ — turn on Analyzer and set it to Post

Seeing what you are cutting is worth more than any preset. Post-EQ analysis shows the result rather than the source.

SOURCE [Apple — Channel EQ parameters in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

172 **GAME CHANGER**

Match EQ — steal a tone rather than guess at it

Learn a reference, learn your track, and Match EQ builds a filter curve from the difference. The Apply slider sets how hard that curve hits: under 100% reduces it, over 100% exaggerates it, and negative values invert its peaks and troughs. Raise Smoothing to even out a spiky curve.

SOURCE [Apple — Match EQ parameters in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Match EQ parameters in Logic Pro for Mac \(MY\)](#) · [Apple — Use Match EQ in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

TIME AND SPACE

173 **GAME CHANGER**

ChromaVerb — use the Damping display as the main control

The Damping EQ overlaid on the main display sets how much of each frequency stays in the reverb decay. Drag the high shelving dot down to shorten the high-end decay and the tail gets darker.

SOURCE [Apple — ChromaVerb display and Damping EQ in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

174

Delay Designer — build rhythmic patterns, not echoes

Each tap has its own delay time plus independent filter cutoff and resonance, transpose, pan and level. Treat it as a sequencer for delay taps and build patterns rather than plain echoes.

SOURCE [Apple — Delay Designer Tap parameter bar in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

175

Stereo Delay — set different times per side

Turn off Stereo Link, then set 1/8 on the left and dotted 1/8 on the right, so each side repeats at its own time.

SOURCE [Apple — Stereo Delay in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

176

Tape Delay — turn up Flutter for analogue character

Flutter Rate and Intensity simulate the speed irregularities of an analogue tape transport, and the LFO adds further delay modulation. The Low and High Cut filters sit in the feedback path, so each repeat gets thinner or darker than the last.

SOURCE [Apple — Tape Delay in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

CHARACTER AND UTILITY

177

Phat FX — one plugin, an entire character chain

Six effects modules in one window — Band-pass, Distortion, Mod FX, Bass Enhancer, Compressor and Filter — plus an assignable X/Y pad, three modulation sources (Env Follower, LFO 1, LFO 2) and an Effect Order strip. Distortion types include Bitcrusher, Diode, Dirt, Downsampler, Grit, Scream, Soft Saturation and Vari Drive.

SOURCE [Apple — Phat FX overview in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Phat FX processors in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

178

Remix FX — perform DJ effects live

Real-time effects including Gater, Downsampler, Reverse and Tape Stop, played from buttons, sliders and XY pads. Apple built it for real-time effects common to electronic and dance music.

SOURCE [Apple — Remix FX in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

179 **GAME CHANGER****Gain — use it to check phase, not just level**

The Gain plugin's Phase Invert button gives you a quick phase check. Flip it, listen for the low end, keep whichever is bigger.

SOURCE [Apple — Gain controls in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

180

Test Oscillator — reference tones for calibration

Generates sine and square waves at an adjustable frequency (1 kHz by default), plus white and pink noise, for use as reference tones.

SOURCE [Apple — Test Oscillator in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 17

More Tricks.

The ones that did not fit anywhere else: templates, key commands, project hygiene, bouncing and the small habits that quietly save hours.

14 TRICKS

KEY COMMANDS AND CUSTOMISATION

181

START HERE

GAME CHANGER

Open Key Commands with $\text{⌘}K$ and use the search box

Open Key Commands with $\text{⌘}K$, type a term in the search field to find a command by name, then assign a key to it.

$\text{⌘}K$

SOURCE [Apple — Assign key commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

182

Save your key commands as a set and back it up

In the Key Commands window ($\text{⌘}K$), click the Actions button, choose Save As, name the set and click Save. That captures your whole set of custom shortcuts, including any Touch Bar assignments. Keep a copy of the file somewhere safe; losing a year of custom shortcuts to a reinstall is entirely avoidable.

SOURCE [Apple — Create custom keyboard shortcuts for Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Assign key commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

183

Save your go-to plug-in chains as channel strip settings

Set up a channel strip with the plug-ins you reach for most, then click the Setting button at the top of the channel strip and choose Save Channel Strip Setting as. A channel strip setting stores the plug-ins and their settings, so choosing it later from the same Setting pop-up menu brings back the whole chain at once.

SOURCE [Apple — Work with channel strip settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

184

Put your key commands on the Touch Bar or a controller button

In the Key Commands window, select a command, click Learn by Touch Bar, tap a Touch Bar button and give it a name. It then appears on the Touch Bar's Keyboard Shortcuts screen. For hardware, select the command (use the Search field) and press a button on your control surface. Its name appears in the Assignments field.

SOURCE [Apple — Create custom keyboard shortcuts for Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Assign controller buttons to key commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

TEMPLATES AND PROJECT MANAGEMENT

185

GAME CHANGER

Build separate templates for writing, mixing and mastering

A writing template loads instantly with a handful of instruments. A mixing template has your buses and reference chain. They are different jobs and they deserve different starting points.

187

Keep a reference track in every project, muted at the top

A commercial track at the top of the session, routed to the master, muted. Unmute it whenever you lose perspective — which will be every hour.

186

Use Project Alternatives instead of Save As

File > Project Alternatives > New Alternative keeps every version inside one project. Apple's guide says alternatives are "saved as part of the project and share the same assets", so you are not duplicating gigabytes of recordings to try a different arrangement.

SOURCE [Apple — Use project alternatives and backups in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

188

Name your bounce files with the date

"Mix_v3.wav" tells you nothing in six weeks.
"Song_2026-04-18_mix3.wav" tells you everything.

BOUNCING AND EXPORT

189 **START HERE**

⌘B bounces the project or the current section

Choose **File > Bounce > Project or Section**, or press ⌘B. With **Cycle mode** off and no regions selected, Logic bounces the whole project. With **Cycle** on, the bounce range matches the locators; with regions selected, it matches the selection. You can also set it with the **Start** and **End** value sliders. Select more than one destination file type to bounce several formats in one pass.

⌘B

SOURCE [Apple — Set the bounce range in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Bounce a project to an audio file in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Why Logic Pro Rules — 10 Logic Pro X Key Commands That Will Rock Your Workflow](#)

190

Check the Normalize setting before you bounce

Both the **project bounce** and **Bounce Regions in Place** have a **Normalize** setting. Off leaves the level alone. **Overload Protection Only** turns the level down only where it would clip above 0 dB. **On** raises the level so the highest peak reaches the maximum possible without clipping.

SOURCE [Apple — Bounce a project to an audio file in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Bounce regions in place in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

191

Bounce offline unless external MIDI or inputs are involved

Offline bouncing is typically faster than realtime. But only internal sources — **audio and software instrument tracks** — can bounce offline, not **MIDI tracks** or **audio channel inputs**. External MIDI sound sources routed to the Mixer through aux channels need Realtime. If you're unsure, choose **Automatic** and Logic decides, based on whether channels have plug-ins that need a realtime bounce.

SOURCE [Apple — Bounce a project to an audio file in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

192

Leave room for tails at the end of the bounce range

To leave room for reverb and delay tails, push the **End** position past the last note with the **End** value slider in the **Bounce dialog** before you bounce. With **Cycle mode** on, you can drag the **right locator** instead, because the bounce range matches the locators. Then listen to the end of the file before you send it.

SOURCE [Apple — Set the bounce range in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

HABITS WORTH BUILDING

193

Colour and name everything before you leave the session

Five minutes at the end of a session saves twenty at the start of the next one.

194

Save a version before every major change

New **Alternative**, then experiment freely. Fear of breaking something is the biggest brake on creative decisions.

SOURCE [Apple — Use project alternatives and backups in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

SECTION 18

Logic Pro 11 Update.

Logic Pro 11 arrived in May 2024 with Session Players, the Chord track, Stem Splitter and ChromaGlow; Flashback Capture followed in 11.2. Stem Splitter and ChromaGlow need a Mac with Apple silicon, running Logic natively rather than in Rosetta. This section covers the new tools.

SOURCE [Apple Newsroom — Logic Pro takes music-making to the next level with new AI features \(May 2024\)](#) · [Apple — If you can't find ChromaGlow, Stem Splitter, or other Logic Pro features on Mac](#) · [Sound On Sound — Apple Logic Pro 11.2 review](#)

195

Use Follow Rhythm Of to lock players together

In the Session Player Editor, click Patterns and look under Follow Rhythm Of. Following the chord rhythm is on by default. For the Bass Player or Keyboard Player, choose a track from the Track pop-up menu to follow its rhythm. For the Drummer, click Patterns for the Kick and Snare kit pieces, then choose a track the same way.

SOURCE [Apple — Follow rhythm of chords and other tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple \(UK\) — Follow rhythm of chords and other tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

196

Session Player performances are per region, so write in sections

The Session Player Editor edits the performance of the selected region, and its Complexity and Intensity sliders adjust that region's performance. Give each song section its own region and set the sliders per region. That is how you get a verse that builds into a chorus.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac Session Player Editor interface](#) · [Apple — The Session Player Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

197

Change style without losing your settings

Before you audition styles, choose Keep Settings when Changing Style from the Preset pop-up menu in the Session Player Editor. Your performance settings then survive the switch, so you hear every style against the same settings. To protect just one parameter, click the lock next to the Fill Amount or Swing knob.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit a Session Player performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Edit a Session Player performance in Logic Pro for iPad](#)

198

Nudge Complexity or Intensity before you rebuild a part

The Complexity and Intensity sliders change the region's performance: higher means a busier or louder part. If a bar is not landing, try nudging those sliders before you rebuild the part from scratch.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit a Session Player performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac Session Player Editor interface](#)

199

Layer two Session Players on the same part

Put two Session Players on the same part: one playing simply, one playing busily, with the busy one low in the mix.

BASS PLAYER

200 **START HERE****Adjust the Complexity slider before you adjust anything else**

Reach for the Complexity slider first: drag it higher for a more complex performance, lower for a plainer one. Low complexity in a verse and high in a chorus is an arrangement decision made with one slider.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit a Session Player performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac Session Player Editor interface](#) · [Sound On Sound — Logic Pro: Session Players](#)

201

Shape the bass articulations in Details

Click Details in the Session Player Editor for bass-specific controls: a Dead Notes knob for percussive, unpitched notes; a Slides knob for how often the player slides between and before notes; a Dynamic Mute button; and a Pickup Hits button for open-palm hits on beats 2 and 4. There are also probability controls for Buzz Trills and Double Stops.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit a Bass Player performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple \(UK\) — Edit a Bass Player performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

202

Pair Bass Player with Studio Bass for its slides

The electric and acoustic Bass Players use dedicated MIDI events and articulations to create slides in the Studio Bass plug-in.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit a Bass Player performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Session Players overview in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

203

Set the Bass Player to follow a specific track's rhythm

In the Session Player Editor, click Patterns, then choose your guitar or piano track from the Track pop-up menu under Follow Rhythm Of. The bass then follows that part's rhythm.

SOURCE [Apple — Follow rhythm of chords and other tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

KEYBOARD PLAYER

204

Use the left- and right-hand controls independently

The left hand has its own Voicing and Style menus; the right hand has its own Voicing and Movement menus. Set the left hand's Style to Sustain Only or Simple and it stays out of the way while the right hand carries the chords, which is useful for comping behind a vocal.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit a Keyboard Player performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple \(MD\) — Edit a Keyboard Player performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

205

Thin out the left hand without touching the right

Complexity and Intensity are different controls: Complexity sets how complex the part is, Intensity how loud and intense. Set them with the sliders, then use the left hand's Style menu (Sustain Only, Simple, Moderate, Complex) to make the left hand sparser or busier independently of the right hand.

SOURCE [Apple \(MD\) — Edit a Keyboard Player performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac Session Player Editor interface](#)

206

Convert to MIDI, then thin out the part

Control-click the Session Player region and choose Convert > Convert to MIDI Region. The result behaves like any other MIDI region, so open it in the Piano Roll and delete the left-hand notes to leave a lighter pad or comp.

SOURCE [Apple — Convert Session Player regions into MIDI or pattern regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

207

Use Keyboard Player as a writing tool, not a final part

Generate a progression, convert it to MIDI, then play the good bits yourself. The generated part becomes your reference.

SOURCE [Apple — Convert Session Player regions into MIDI or pattern regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

208

Try the Synth Player styles, not just piano

Session Players include Synth Player styles. For keys: Rhythmic Chords, Modulated Pad and Simple Pad. For bass: 808 Bass, Pump Bass and Sequenced Bass. Choosing one loads a patch that uses Alchemy.

SOURCE [Apple — Intro to Synth Player styles in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Edit a Synth Keyboard Player performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

THE CHORD TRACK

209

START HERE

GAME CHANGER

Show the Chord track in Global Tracks

Press **G** to show the global tracks, then choose **Track > Global Tracks > Configure Global Tracks** and select **Chord**. Session Player regions without their own region chords follow the progression you enter there.

G

SOURCE [Apple — Show and hide global tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Choose which chords a Session Player region follows in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

210

Generate chords from an existing region

Drag a MIDI or audio region onto the Chord track and Logic analyses it and adds its chords as a chord group. Or Control-click the region, choose **Chords > Analyze Chords**, then **Chords > Apply Region Chords to Chord Track**.

SOURCE [Apple — Analyze the chords in audio or MIDI regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

211

Resize chords by dragging their lower edges

Move the pointer over the lower-left or lower-right edge of a chord until it becomes the **Resize** pointer, then drag to shorten or lengthen it.

SOURCE [Apple — Move and resize chords in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

212

Use Pitch Source to keep parts off the Chord track

Select the region and open the **Pitch Source** pop-up in the Region inspector. Chord Track makes it follow your progression; **Region Chords**, **Key Signature** or **Off** take it off the Chord track. Use that for loops and parts you have already committed.

SOURCE [Apple — Control transposition with the Pitch Source parameter in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Choose which chords a Session Player region follows in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

STEM SPLITTER

213

START HERE

GAME CHANGER

Split any mixed audio into stems

Control-click an audio region and choose **Processing > Stem Splitter**. Since 11.2 it separates up to six stems — **vocals**, **drums**, **bass**, **guitar**, **piano** and **other** — and it needs an Apple silicon Mac.

SOURCE [Apple — Extract vocal and instrumental stems with Stem Splitter in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Why Logic Pro Rules — Logic Pro 11.2 Update is Out! Improved Stem Splitter](#) · [Production Expert — Apple Updates Logic Pro with Improved Stem Separation](#)

214

Use it on your own rough mixes, not just other people's records

It is especially handy for recovering a part from a bounce of your own song when the original session is gone.

SOURCE [Apple — Extract vocal and instrumental stems with Stem Splitter in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

215

Solo each stem and listen before you commit

Stem Splitter can leave artefacts: bits of a vocal sometimes land in the wrong stem, and results depend on how busy the mix is and how much reverb and delay it has. Solo each stem from its subtrack header and listen for artefacts before you build on it.

SOURCE [Sound On Sound — Logic Pro: How To Get The Best From The Stem Splitter](#) · [Sound On Sound — Logic Pro: How To Use The Stem Splitter](#) · [Apple — Extract vocal and instrumental stems with Stem Splitter in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

216

Try single stems as layers first

Tuck a split stem under your other parts before you rely on it on its own, and listen for artefacts either way.

217

START HERE

Make an instrumental with one preset

Stem Splitter's presets cover the common jobs in one click: Acapella gives you the vocal, Instrumental removes it. Or tick stems yourself. Selected stems come out individually, and two or more unselected stems are combined into a submix, which you extract by selecting the Submix checkbox.

SOURCE [Apple Newsroom — Logic Pro amplifies beat making on Mac and iPad with advanced new capabilities](#) · [Apple — Extract vocal and instrumental stems with Stem Splitter in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

218

Splitting adds rather than replaces

Clicking Apply creates a summing stack below the track holding the selected region, with the extracted stems on its subtracks. The original region is muted so you hear the stems straight away. It is still there if you want to go back to it.

SOURCE [Apple — Extract vocal and instrumental stems with Stem Splitter in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

CHROMAGLOW

219

GAME CHANGER

ChromaGlow is five saturation models in one plugin

The Model menu offers Retro Tube, Modern Tube, Magnetic, Squeeze and Analog Preamp, and each has its own character. Audition all five on the source before you start adjusting the other controls. ChromaGlow needs a Mac with Apple silicon, running Logic natively rather than in Rosetta.

SOURCE [Apple — ChromaGlow in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [MusicRadar — Apple Logic Pro for Mac 11/Logic Pro for iPad 2 review](#) · [Logic Studio Training — ChromaGlow in Logic Pro: 5 Models, 10 Styles Explained](#) · [Apple — If you can't find ChromaGlow, Stem Splitter, or other Logic Pro features on Mac](#)

220

Use Drive and Level Out together to stay level-matched

Drive sets how much saturation you get, and Level Out sets the plug-in's output gain. When you push Drive, pull Level Out down so you are comparing at matched loudness. Otherwise you are only hearing louder, not better.

SOURCE [Apple — ChromaGlow in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

221

Try it before the compressor on the drum bus

Put ChromaGlow before the compressor on the drum bus, then swap the order and compare. Keep whichever sounds more controlled to you.

222

Use Bypass Below to keep the low end clean

ChromaGlow's Bypass Below control leaves everything under the frequency you set unsaturated, so the bass stays solid while the mids and top take the colour.

SOURCE [Apple — ChromaGlow in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

223

Try it on the master at very low drive

Try a very small amount across the whole mix. If you can obviously hear it, back it off.

2 2 4

START HERE

GAME CHANGER

Flashback Capture retrieves what you just played

Logic's MIDI-only Capture Recording was renamed Flashback Capture in 11.2 and can now capture audio as well. A vocal run you played while Logic wasn't recording is recoverable too, as long as the project was playing. Use the control bar button, or press ⌘ R.

⌘ R

SOURCE [Sound On Sound — Apple Logic Pro 11.2 review](#) · [Apple — Capture a recent audio performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

2 2 5

MIDI capture works with the transport stopped

MIDI is caught whether the project is playing or stopped, so noodling with the song stopped is safe. Audio, added in 11.2, can be captured only while the project is playing, so leave the transport rolling when the mic is what you might want back.

SOURCE [Apple — Capture your most recent MIDI performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Capture a recent audio performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Sound On Sound — Apple Logic Pro 11.2 review](#)

2 2 6

Check plug-in compatibility after updating

Logic scans your plug-ins the first time it opens after an update. Before relying on a new version for real work, open the Plug-in Manager and look for 'failed validation' in the Compatibility column. Select that plug-in and click Reset & Rescan Selection. If it fails again, check with the developer for an update.

SOURCE [Apple — If Logic Pro for Mac hangs after updating](#) · [Apple — Use the Plug-in Manager in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — If you can't find a recently installed plug-in for Logic Pro for Mac or MainStage](#)

SECTION 19

Logic Pro 12 Update.

Logic Pro 12 arrived on 28 January 2026. It runs only on Macs with Apple silicon and needs macOS Sequoia 15.6 or later. The headline additions are the Synth Player and Chord ID. This section covers what is new, plus an upgrade playbook for any major release.

SOURCE [Apple Newsroom — Introducing Apple Creator Studio \(January 2026\)](#) · [Production Expert — Logic Pro 12: AI features, new tools and Intel Mac support dropped](#)

23 TRICKS

One requirement before anything else

Logic Pro 12 requires an Apple silicon Mac running macOS 15.6 or later. There is no Intel version. If you are still on an Intel machine, Logic Pro 11 is the end of the road — plan around that before you update anything.

SOURCE [Production Expert — Logic Pro 12: AI features, new tools and Intel Mac support dropped](#) · [Apple Newsroom — Introducing Apple Creator Studio \(January 2026\)](#)

WHAT'S NEW IN LOGIC PRO 12

2 2 7 **GAME CHANGER**

Synth Player lives inside Bass Player and Keyboard Player

Synth Player is not a new Session Player. It is a set of styles inside the Bass Player and Keyboard Player you already have. Create a Bass Player or Keyboard Player track, open the Session Player Editor and choose a Synth style. Both players can follow the Chord track, so one progression drives bass and keys together.

SOURCE [Apple — Intro to Synth Player styles in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Chords and Session Players in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

2 2 8

Pick the Synth Keyboard style before you touch anything else

The Synth Keyboard Player has three styles: Rhythmic Chords, Modulated Pad and Simple Pad. Audition all three against the same chords before you start editing.

SOURCE [Apple — Intro to Synth Player styles in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

2 2 9

Synth Bass ships with three distinct characters

The Synth Bass Player has three styles: 808 Bass, Pump Bass and Sequenced Bass. Audition all three before you start editing the pattern.

SOURCE [Apple — Intro to Synth Player styles in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac release notes](#)

2 3 0

Shape the Pump Bass pump directly

Pump Bass gets its pumping from modulated ducking, like a sidechained compressor, and you can shape it. In the Session Player Editor, click the Details button. Drag the Amount knob vertically to set how hard it ducks, and the Shape knob to change the ducking curve.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit a Synth Bass Player performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

2 3 1

Point Synth Player at a third-party synth

The performance and the sound source are separate. A Synth Player style loads an Alchemy patch by default, but you can use Synth Players with any software instrument plug-in or an external MIDI tone generator. You keep the chord-following performance and choose your own sound.

SOURCE [Apple — Intro to Synth Player styles in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

2 3 2 **GAME CHANGER**

Chord ID reads chords off audio, not just MIDI

Drag a guitar demo, a piano take or a rough bounce onto the Chord track. Chord ID analyses the region and adds the chords it finds to the Chord track as a chord group. It works on audio and MIDI regions, and Apple says it handles single instruments and full mixes.

SOURCE [Apple — Analyze the chords in audio or MIDI regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac release notes](#)

233

Check Chord ID's chords before you build on them

Chord ID writes what it finds straight onto the Chord track as a chord group. Play it back against the source before you build on it. If a chord is wrong, edit it on the Chord track: you can change the root note and chord type, add or remove extensions, and set a bass note other than the root.

SOURCE [Apple — Analyze the chords in audio or MIDI regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Edit chords in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

234

GAME CHANGER

Everything downstream follows the Chord track

Once Chord ID has populated the Chord track, other tracks can lock to it. Apple: "By following the Chord track, multiple tracks — such as tracks using Step Sequencer, Session Player tracks, and other software instrument tracks — can play in sync harmonically." Set a Session Player region to follow with Control-click > Chords > Follow Global Chord Track; set a Step Sequencer pattern to follow by choosing Chord Track, which renames the note rows to chord degrees. One analysis pass can arrange several parts at once.

SOURCE [Apple — Choose which chords a Session Player region follows in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Chords and pitch in Step Sequencer in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Overview of chords in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

235

Run Chord ID on your own old bounces

Lost the project but kept the bounce? Drag the bounce onto the Chord track and Chord ID adds its chords there as a chord group. Check them against the bounce, fix any that are wrong, then rebuild from there.

SOURCE [Apple — Analyze the chords in audio or MIDI regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac release notes](#)

236

Preview sound packs before you download them

Open Logic Pro > Sound Library and click a sound pack to preview it before you commit to downloading. It is also where you reclaim space: click Manage Packs, then click Delete next to a pack you no longer need. The total space all installed packs use is shown at the top of the list, and each pack's size appears in the list.

SOURCE [Apple — Download additional sound packs in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac release notes](#)

237

Missing sounds after upgrading? Install the Legacy packs

Logic Pro 12.2 added three sound packs to reinstall content that was missing from the first release of Logic Pro 12: Logic Pro Legacy Patches, Logic Pro Legacy Instruments and Logic Pro Legacy Loops. Open Logic Pro > Sound Library and click Get next to the ones you need.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac release notes](#) · [Apple — Download additional sound packs in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

238

Reanalyze and try each Character

When the mix changes, click Reanalyze in Mastering Assistant so it analyses the project again. Then try the Character options: Transparent (the default), Clean, Valve and Punch. A/B each against the master you signed off on before you call it finished. Transparent, Punch and Valve require an Apple silicon Mac.

SOURCE [Apple — Mastering Assistant parameters in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Use Mastering Assistant in Logic Pro](#)

BEFORE YOU UPDATE

239

GAME CHANGER

Logic Pro 12 drops Intel Macs entirely

Logic Pro 12 requires a Mac with Apple silicon and macOS 15.6 or later. If you are on an Intel Mac you can't run it, so check your machine before you plan an upgrade.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac - Technical Specifications](#) · [Apple Support — Logic Pro - Tech Specs](#)

240

GAME CHANGER

Never update in the middle of a paid project

The one rule that matters. Finish and deliver, then update. A new version halfway through a mix is a self-inflicted deadline problem.

2 4 1

Back up the current version before you update

Use Apple's procedure. Make a folder in Applications named for the version (for example "Logic Pro 11.1.2"), select Logic Pro and choose File > Compress "Logic Pro", then move Logic Pro.zip into that folder. If the update causes problems, reinstall the backed-up version.

SOURCE [Apple Support — Back up Logic Pro for Mac](#)

2 4 2

Back up your key commands and channel strip settings

Choose Logic Pro > Key Commands > Edit, click the Actions button, choose Save As, name your set and save it somewhere safe, such as an external drive. Your channel strip settings live in ~/Music/Audio Music Apps/Channel Strip Settings, so copy that folder too.

SOURCE [Apple Support — Create custom keyboard shortcuts for Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Logic Studio Training Wiki — Channel strip settings](#) · [macProVideo — Demystifying Logic Pro X's Plug-In Settings, Channel Strip Settings & Patches](#)

2 4 3

Consolidate and archive your three most important projects

File > Project Management > Consolidate on each, then copy them to a separate drive. If the new version changes something, you have untouched originals.

SOURCE [Apple Support — Consolidate assets in a Logic Pro for Mac project](#)

2 4 4

Check your critical third-party plugins against the new version first

Check each plug-in developer's compatibility notes before you update Logic, not after.

2 4 5

Note your current I/O and buffer settings

Screenshot your Audio settings before you update — output device, input device and I/O buffer size. It takes five seconds, and if anything about your setup looks different afterwards you can restore the exact configuration you were working with instead of guessing at it.

SOURCE [Apple Support — Avoid system overloads in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [macProVideo — Logic Pro X Audio Preferences Explained](#)

2 4 6

Update macOS and Logic separately, a week apart

If something breaks, you want to know which of the two did it.

2 4 7

Read the new Key Commands list for additions

After every update, choose Logic Pro > Key Commands > Edit and browse for commands you haven't seen before. Click Unused to show commands that have no shortcut yet. For any you'll use, select it, click Learn by Key Label and press the keys you want.

SOURCE [Apple Support — Create custom keyboard shortcuts for Logic Pro for Mac](#)

2 4 8

Test your bounce path end to end before you need it

Bounce a short section to every format you deliver in, so any problem turns up before a deadline does.

2 4 9

Give yourself a deliberate hour to explore

Not on a project. Open a scratch session and use every new feature once. An hour of play beats a month of accidental discovery.

Glossary

Every Logic word used in this book, in plain English. Each definition cites where it was checked.

Audio

Recorded sound — a voice, a guitar, anything captured through a microphone or input — stored in audio files and placed on audio tracks as audio regions.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

Automation

Recorded or drawn changes to a control over time — a fader rising, a filter opening — that Logic plays back for you. Volume, pan, sends and most plug-in settings can be automated.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Overview of automation in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Aux

also: aux channel strip, auxiliary

An aux (auxiliary) channel strip receives sound sent to it over a bus, so it can be processed or combined into a submix.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

Backup

also: backups, Project Alternative

Each time you save, Logic keeps a backup of the project — up to ten per project alternative — which you can go back to with File > Revert to.

SOURCE [Apple — Use project alternatives and backups in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Bounce

also: bouncing, export

Turning your project, or part of it, into a new audio file. Bounce in Place does this to selected regions, keeping their plug-ins and automation in the result.

SOURCE [Apple — Bounce a project to an audio file in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac bounce in place overview](#)

Buffer

also: I/O buffer, buffer size

The chunk of audio your Mac processes at a time. A smaller I/O buffer means less latency but more strain on the processor; too small for your Mac and you hear clicks, pops and crackles.

SOURCE [Apple — Configure audio devices to use with Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Bus

also: buses, busses

A route that carries sound from a send to an aux channel strip, where it can be processed or mixed with other tracks.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

Channel strip

also: channel strips

The on-screen version of a strip on a mixing desk: a volume fader, a pan knob, a Mute button, and slots for inputs, outputs, sends and effects. Your tracks' sound runs through their channel strips.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Channel strip controls in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Chord track

A global track that holds your song's chord progression, so Session Players can follow the same chords and play in sync.

SOURCE [Apple — Chords and Session Players in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Comp

also: comping, comps

Short for composite: the best sections of several takes combined into one performance, shown in the top lane of a take folder.

SOURCE [Apple — Create and save comps in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Count-in

also: count in

A lead-in of bars or beats before recording starts, so you are ready to come in.

SOURCE [Apple — Recording project settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Cycle

also: cycle area, cycle mode

A section of the timeline that plays over and over while Cycle mode is on — for writing, practising a part or recording several takes.

SOURCE [Apple — Use the cycle area in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

Drum Machine Designer

also: DMD

A drum instrument laid out as pads. Every pad you fill gets its own subtrack and channel strip, so each drum sound can be processed on its own.

SOURCE [Apple — Drum Machine Designer in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Fade

also: fades, fade-in, fade-out

A gradual change in volume at the start (fade-in) or end (fade-out) of a region. A short fade-in also prevents the click you can get when audio starts abruptly.

SOURCE [Why Logic Pro Rules — How to Get the Most Out of Logic Pro X's Fade Tool](#) · [Apple — Snap to zero in the Logic Pro for Mac Audio Track Editor](#)

Flex

also: Flex Time, flex markers

Flex Time changes the timing inside recorded audio by stretching and squeezing the audio between markers, instead of cutting it into pieces.

SOURCE [Apple — Flex tool time stretching in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Gain

A region's level. The Region inspector's Gain setting changes how loud an audio region plays without changing the file.

SOURCE [Apple — Change the gain of audio regions in the Tracks area in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Global tracks

also: global track

Song-wide tracks above your regular tracks — by default Arrangement, Marker, Signature and Tempo. Press G to show them.

SOURCE [Apple — Show and hide global tracks in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Inspector

also: Region inspector

A panel that shows settings for whatever is selected. The Region inspector, for example, shows the playback settings of the selected regions.

SOURCE [Apple — Use the Region inspector in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Key command

also: key commands, shortcut, keyboard shortcut

A keyboard shortcut for a Logic command. You can find, search and change them in the Key Commands window (Option-K).

SOURCE [Apple — Assign key commands in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Latency

A delay between a sound going in and you hearing it come out. Processing takes time, so plug-ins and the audio buffer both add latency — which you notice most while recording.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Work with plug-in latencies in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Configure audio devices to use with Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Library

The panel where you choose a patch for the selected track: categories on the left, patches on the right. Click the Library button in the control bar to open it.

SOURCE [Apple — Choose patches in the Library in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Locators

also: left locator, right locator

The left and right locators mark the start and end of the cycle area.

SOURCE [Apple — Use the cycle area in Logic Pro \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

Marker

also: markers

A named flag on the timeline for labelling parts of your song and jumping between them.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac markers overview](#)

Marquee tool

also: marquee

A tool that selects a range of time instead of whole regions. Drag across one or more tracks and only the part inside is selected, ready to move, cut, copy or delete.

SOURCE [Apple — Select parts of regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Metronome

A regular click that marks the beat so you can play in time.

SOURCE [Apple — Metronome project settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

MIDI

Musical Instrument Digital Interface. MIDI is note information — which pitch, how long, how loud — sent between keyboards, computers and instruments. It is not sound itself; an instrument turns it into sound.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Use MIDI plug-ins in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Mixer

The window that shows every track's channel strip side by side, so you can balance levels and set up effects. Press X to show or hide it.

SOURCE [Apple — Overview of mixing in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

Patch

also: patches

A ready-made sound you load onto a track. It can include the instrument, its effects and other channel strip settings.

SOURCE [Apple — Patches in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Choose patches in the Library in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Piano Roll

also: Piano Roll Editor

The editor that shows the notes in a MIDI region as bars on a grid beside a piano-style keyboard, where you add, move and edit them. Press P with a MIDI region selected.

SOURCE [Apple — Overview of the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Playhead

The vertical line that shows where playback is. Drag it to hear a different point in the song.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

Plug-in

also: plugin, plug-ins, plugins

An add-on that gives a track its sound or changes it — usually a software instrument or an effect.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

Quantize

also: quantise, quantization

Moving notes so they start exactly on the nearest point of a timing grid, tightening up playing that is slightly early or late.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

Quick Sampler

A built-in instrument that turns a single audio file into something you can play on a keyboard. To work with more than one audio file at once, use Sampler instead.

SOURCE [Apple — Quick Sampler overview in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Choose a Quick Sampler mode in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Region

also: regions

A block on a track that holds a piece of your recording. Audio regions point to part of an audio file; MIDI regions hold notes. You build a song by moving, copying and editing regions.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Capture your most recent MIDI performance in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Send

also: sends

A control on a channel strip that routes its sound along a bus to an aux channel strip. Choose a bus in a Send slot and Logic creates the aux for you.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Send signals to multiple destinations in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Session Player

also: Session Players, Drummer, Bass Player, Keyboard Player, Synth Player

Logic's built-in virtual musicians. Drummer was joined by Bass Player and Keyboard Player in Logic Pro 11, and by Synth Player in Logic Pro 12. Bass Player and Keyboard Player can follow your chord progression.

SOURCE [Apple Newsroom — Logic Pro takes music-making to the next level with new AI features \(May 2024\)](#) · [Apple Newsroom — Introducing Apple Creator Studio \(January 2026\)](#) · [Apple — Chords and Session Players in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Smart Controls

A set of on-screen knobs for shaping the selected track's sound — usually tone and EQ, reverb and other effects — without opening each plug-in. Press B to show them.

SOURCE [Apple — Overview of Smart Controls in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Snap

Makes edits land on the nearest grid position — a bar, a beat or a finer division — so things stay in time. Turn it on or off with the button next to the Snap menu.

SOURCE [Apple — Snap items to the grid in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Software instrument

also: instrument, software instruments

An instrument that runs inside Logic — a synthesizer, a sampler or a re-creation of a vintage instrument — played with MIDI from a keyboard or from MIDI regions.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Instruments introduction for Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Use MIDI plug-ins in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Stem

also: stems, Stem Splitter

One part of a mix on its own — vocals, drums, bass and so on. Stem Splitter pulls stems out of a single mixed recording, on Macs with Apple silicon.

SOURCE [Apple — Extract vocal and instrumental stems with Stem Splitter in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — If you can't find ChromaGlow, Stem Splitter, or other Logic Pro features on Mac](#)

Step Sequencer

An editor for building beats and patterns one step at a time on a grid of rows. Each row can have its own length and step rate.

SOURCE [Apple — Edit Step Sequencer pattern, row, and step settings in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Take

also: takes, take folder

Each pass you record over the same spot is a take. Logic keeps them in a take folder, and its pop-up menu lists them so you can pick one.

SOURCE [Apple — Preview take recordings in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Create and save comps in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Tempo

also: bpm

The speed of the music in beats per minute (bpm). At 120 bpm there are 120 beats every minute.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

Track

A horizontal lane in the Tracks area where you record, play back and edit regions. Each track plays through its own channel strip in the Mixer.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

Track Stack

also: Track Stacks, folder stack, summing stack

A group of tracks under one main track. A folder stack just keeps them tidy; a summing stack also routes them to a bus so you can process them together.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro for Mac track stacks overview](#)

Tracks area

The main part of the Logic window, where your tracks and their regions sit.

SOURCE [Apple — Select parts of regions in Logic Pro for Mac](#) · [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#)

Transient

also: transients

The sharp start of a sound, like a drum hit. Logic can detect transients — for example to cut a loop into slices in Quick Sampler.

SOURCE [Apple — Quick Sampler Slice mode in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

Velocity

How hard a note was played, from 0 to 127. It usually sets the note's loudness, and can shape other parts of the sound too.

SOURCE [Apple — Logic Pro Glossary \(Logic Pro 10.7 guide\)](#) · [Apple — Edit velocity in the Piano Roll Editor in Logic Pro for Mac](#)

That's the 249.

Now close the book and go and finish the song. The tricks are only worth something once they are muscle memory, and muscle memory only comes from sessions.

Come back whenever you get stuck. Every section is one click away from every page — that is the entire point of it.

Logic Pro Crash Course · Covers Logic Pro 11 and 12
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